Memory Is Not Enough: Separating Drift from Background Conflict in Continual Document Understanding

Supplementary Material

Roadmap. This appendix holds the detail behind every claim of the main paper, which is organised as a ladder of hypotheses (its Tab. 1); material that left the main body in the restructure (the memory × readout factorial as a table and a figure, the drift evidence with its four-encoder table, and the memory-content ladder with the compression trade-off) is here, in Appendices E and F. Appendix A gives the datasets, the exact session composition of each scenario and the clean protocol in full. Appendix B defines the three ways we score a class-incremental session, works one receipt through them, and compares session-restricted AA with the mask-free full-label F1. Appendix C describes CoLaR, SBR and SBR-Recall at the level of the code, with the supervision plan of every (session, block) pair, pseudo-code and memory accounting. Appendix D gives the retention matrices, the per-seed values behind every headline cell, the LexSlot stacking comparison, SBR-Recall on the mixed stream and the delta-capacity ablation. Appendix E collects the evidence that the background conflict sits in the labels and not in the memory; Appendix F does the same for drift, with the measurements the main paper only summarises, and holds the falsification ledger, the memory-content ladder and the image comparison. Appendix G documents the baselines, our ports and the settings of every legacy-protocol (†) cell, and Appendix H lists what is needed to reproduce the runs. Appendix I draws the results as figures, and Appendix J holds the related work and the comparators that left the main body. Every number in the generated tables is read from the run files by our table generator; a † marks a legacy-protocol source, "clean" the clean protocol, and "gate", "rescore" and "grid" name the three groups of legacy runs described in Appendix G.

A. Setup details

Datasets. FUNSD (`nielsr/funsd-layoutlmv3`; 149/50 train/test forms), CORD (`naver-clova-ix/cord-v2`; 800/100/100 receipts), SROIE (`mp-02/sroie`; 626/347 receipts). We use the dataset-provided OCR and boxes throughout, page images at 224×224 and a text length of 512 tokens; with the 197 image tokens of LayoutLMv3 a document is a sequence of 709 positions.

CIL-CORD. CORD's 30 fine-grained classes (61 BIO tags with "O") arrive in five sessions of six classes (Tab. 1). A session's training and test pools keep every receipt that contains at least one of that session's entities, and every token of a class outside the session is labelled "O". The head grows by twelve tags per session. Joint training uses the full-label pool (each receipt once, with all its labels) rather than the concatenation of the masked per-session copies, which would feed contradictory labels for the same document. Class imbalance across sessions is left as it is.

Table 1. **CIL-CORD sessions** (the canonical partition of our scenario builder). Pool: receipts of the CORD training split that contain at least one of the session's entities; under the clean protocol 10% of each pool is held out for early stopping (the per-epoch step counts at batch size 2 in the clean logs, 360/172/247/326/351, match 90% of the pools).

Session	Classes (prefix `menu.`, `sub_total.`, `total.` as listed)	Pool
1	menu: cnt, discountprice, itemsubtotal, nm, num, price	800
2	menu: unitprice, vatyn, sub.cnt, sub.nm, sub.price, sub.unitprice	382
3	sub_total: discount_price, etc, othersvc_price, service_price, subtotal_price, tax_price	549
4	total: cashprice, changeprice, creditcardprice, emoneyprice, menuqty_cnt, menutype_cnt	723
5	total.total_etc, total.total_price, void_menu.nm, void_menu.price, sub.nm, sub.cnt	780

Table 2. **Mixed sessions**. Schema: the dataset whose annotation scheme the session uses, which SBR's supervision rule reads (Appendix C.2). Pool: training documents, read from the per-epoch step counts at batch size 2 of the fp32 gate run of CoLaR-SBR on Mixed, seed 42 (no held-out split), so ±1 where the last batch holds one document.

Session	Dataset	Tags introduced	Schema	Pool
1	FUNSD	HEADER, QUESTION	funsd	149
2	FUNSD	ANSWER	funsd	147–148
3	SROIE	COMPANY, DATE, ADDRESS, TOTAL	sroie	625–626
4	CORD (super)	menu, sub_total	cord	799–800
5	CORD (super)	total, void_menu, sub	cord	797–798
6	FUNSD	none (all FUNSD labels)	funsd	149

Mixed. Six sessions over three datasets and three annotation schemas (FUNSD for forms; SROIE and CORD for receipts; Tab. 2): two class-incremental FUNSD sessions, a domain shift to SROIE, two class-incremental sessions on CORD's super-classes, and a return to FUNSD with all its labels. The head grows to 25 tags; the FUNSD revisit adds none. Boundaries therefore alternate between new classes within a dataset and a new dataset, and the last session checks retention of the first.

DIL unified schema. A single four-entity label space {HEADER, KEY, VALUE, OTHER} (9 BIO tags) is held fixed over FUNSD→SROIE→CORD.

FUNSD: HEADER→HEADER, QUESTION→KEY, ANSWER→VALUE. SROIE: COMPANY→KEY; ADDRESS/DATE/TOTAL→VALUE. CORD: menu/sub_total/total→VALUE; void_menu/sub→OTHER. KEY originates only from FUNSD and SROIE, so the schema is VALUE-dominant; we report per-class F1 for every DIL result and treat a high aggregate as retention only if the sparse classes are retained. The reverse order is used as a robustness check.

Backbones. LayoutLMv3-base is the primary encoder (text, layout and image patches in one sequence). LiLT and BROS are text-and-layout encoders and BERT-base is text only; all four have twelve layers of width 768. Every head is a single linear layer: an MLP head with ten or more labels saturates and collapses to all-background after class-incremental expansion. When the head grows, old rows are kept and new rows are drawn from $\mathcal{N}(0, 0.02^2)$.

The clean protocol in full. Every clean run uses fp32, batch size 2 with gradient checkpointing, AdamW with learning rate 5×10^{-5}, weight decay 0.01 and gradient clipping 1.0. Each session trains for at most 10 epochs (100 for joint training) and stops early when the F1 on a held-out split has not improved by 0.1 points for 2 epochs, after which the best weights are restored. The held-out split is 10% of that session's *training* pool, drawn with a generator seeded by the run seed plus the session index (the run seed for joint training), and scored with the same session restriction as the test, so a prediction of another session's class is neither rewarded nor charged there; the test split is never used for model selection. Class-incremental sessions are scored with session-restricted scoring (Appendix B); on CIL-CORD the final model is also scored on the unmasked test set (full-label F1). Mixed and DIL have no full-label set, so the column is CIL-CORD only. Seeds are 42, 7 and 123. CoLaR-family runs use k=4, rank r=128, 50 stored documents per session and 4 replayed documents per step; the clean ER row keeps 250 raw documents, as many as CoLaR stores on CIL-CORD. A table cell switches to the clean protocol only when all three clean seeds exist, so no cell mixes the protocols.

Compute. The runs reported here ran on a single 6 GB GPU, except some first-grid rows (Appendix H). Per-run times of the headline cells are in Tab. 7 and Appendix H.

B. Scoring, explained

Definitions. Let $\mathcal{A}_j$ be the tags of session j and $\mathcal{D}_j$ its test documents, whose gold labels show only $\mathcal{A}_j$ (every other entity is "O"). All three scores are entity-level F1 from `seqeval`.

- *Legacy scoring* compares the model's raw predictions on $\mathcal{D}_j$ with the masked gold labels.
- *Session-restricted scoring* first maps every predicted tag outside $\mathcal{A}_j$ to "O" and then compares. It does not re-take the argmax among the tags of $\mathcal{A}_j$: a token whose best tag belongs to another session becomes "O", never its second-best in-session tag. For SBR the mapping is applied after the block decision of Eq. (1).
- *Full-label F1* scores the final model, with no mapping, on the unmasked CORD test set (all 100 receipts, all 30 classes).

A worked example. Take one receipt with a menu item name (class `menu.nm`, session 1) and the total price (`total.total_price`, session 5), and a model that labels both correctly. In session 1's test labels the total price is "O", so under legacy scoring the correct total-price span is a false positive there: precision $1/2$, recall 1, F1 0.67 for session 1 on this receipt. Symmetrically, the correct menu-name span is a false positive in session 5. A perfect model is charged once in every session that does not own a predicted entity, so legacy scoring penalises the model for knowing more classes, and the penalty grows with the number of sessions; this is why joint training, which labels every class, reads 33.3 under legacy scoring on CIL-CORD (Tab. 23) and 91.3 ± 0.8 under restricted scoring (different runs). Under legacy scoring naive training, LwF, ER and DER++ sit at 16–19 AA on average on CIL-CORD (Tab. 23), a band that could be read as a floor of the scenario; most of it is this artefact. Under session-restricted scoring the total-price prediction is mapped to "O" in session 1 and counts in session 5 only, so both sessions score 1. If instead the model labels the total price as `menu.price` (a session-1 class), the predicted span is a false positive in session 1 and the gold total is a miss in session 5: one false positive and one false negative, exactly what ordinary entity F1 charges for a wrong type.

Why restricted scoring charges each error at most once. Every predicted entity has one class, and that class belongs to exactly one session; outside that session the mapping removes it, so it can be a false positive only in its owning session. Every gold entity appears unmasked only in the test labels of its own session, so it can be a false negative only there. A confusion between sessions therefore still costs a miss. The caveat is coverage: $\mathcal{D}_j$ keeps only receipts that contain an entity of session j, so a false positive of a session-j class on a receipt without any session-j entity is never counted. Full-label F1 has no such gap, which is why we report it.

Where the two metrics agree. Tab. 4 lists every clean-protocol run that records both numbers. On every seed

both metrics order the same groups: naive training and no-memory SBR, then CoLaR with a shared softmax, then the true-label refresh, then CoLaR-SBR, SBR-Recall and joint training. Inside a group they can disagree on the order: naive training and no-memory SBR swap on two seeds, and so do runs of the top group that are within about a point of each other. For CoLaR-SBR, SBR-Recall and joint training the two metrics differ by at most 1.3 points on each seed, so for these runs the restricted AA of the main comparison (Tab. 3 of the main paper) is not inflated by the coverage gap. For weak models restricted AA is the more lenient of the two, by 4.8 to 12.3 points for the runs without a memory and 1.2 to 5.2 for CoLaR: no-memory SBR reads 21.6 ± 2.2 AA against 11.4 ± 2.3 full-label F1, because a session's test split keeps only receipts that contain its entities, so most of that model's false positives on other receipts go uncounted (the coverage caveat above). The true-label refresh is the exception in the other direction (full-label F1 above AA); Appendix E explains it. The table is regenerated as clean runs complete.

Why the two metrics weight differently. AA averages the five sessions, whereas full-label F1 counts entities, and the sessions are unequal: session 1 holds 57% of the 1,306 gold spans of the CORD test set (Fig. 1). Every gold span sits, complete, in the test split of exactly one session, so pooling a final model's per-session true positives and misses gives its full-label true positives and misses. Pooled per-session F1 reproduces full-label F1 within 0.4 points for every clean run with per-session counts except the blocked readout without memory, which it overstates by up to 3.8: a session's split omits receipts without that session's entities, so that model's many false positives there go uncounted.

A span-level indicator, and where it fails. Given the exact true positives and misses, the full-label F1 fixes the number of false-positive spans. A missed gold span that receives any wrong predicted span costs at least one false positive, so (misses − false positives)/misses would lower-bound the share of missed spans labelled entirely "O" if every wrong predicted span overlapped at most one missed gold span. That proviso fails when wrong tags run together into long spans: for the blocked readout without memory the quantity reads up to 81%, while its per-token outputs show no old entity token predicted "O" (Tab. 3). It is therefore an indicator, not a bound, and it can overstate the share. With a shared softmax it reads 89 to 95% for CoLaR and at least 98% for naive training, which keeps no old span: under this readout it is high with or without a memory, so it does not tell the two apart. The same exact false-positive count does give a bound on CoLaR's old-span precision: every false positive of an old class is one of the full test set's false positives, so old-span precision is at least 71.6% on every seed. Per-token outputs of the shared-softmax runs will replace the indicator.

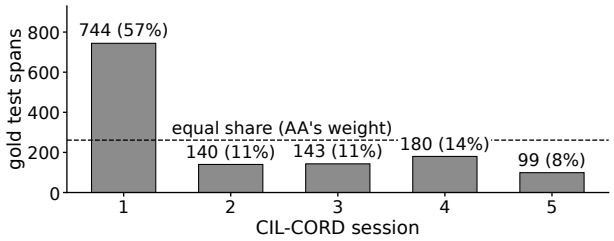


Figure 1. **Gold test spans per CIL-CORD session.** AA gives each session the same weight (dashed line); full-label F1 counts entities, so session 1 weighs most. Generated from the mechanism analysis.

The measures of Tab. 3. *Spans*: old-session spans (sessions 1 to 4) pooled over their own splits under session-restricted scoring. For shared-softmax runs R and P come from per-class reports, which omit the false positives of classes absent from a split, so P is an upper bound there; for every run the splits omit receipts without that session's entities, so P overstates precision on the full test set. *Missed at O^t*: the indicator above, over all sessions' missed spans; it is printed only where no per-token outputs exist (for the blocked readouts the implied false positives exceed the misses, the quantity is negative and would clip at 0). *Tokens*: first-subword gold entity tokens of the old sessions on their own splits. Owner: the arg-max block above the 0.5 threshold is the gold class's session. The wrong ones are split into predicted "O", another tag of their own session (a B/I swap of the right type included) and a class of another session; the three shares sum to 100. *False claims*: tokens of session t's split that are not session-t entities (true background or other sessions' entities, on receipts selected for containing a session-t entity), claimed by block t; each such claim is an error whatever the token is.

C. Method details

C.1. CoLaR

What is stored. After the first session, the embeddings and layers $1..k$ are frozen; everything above, and the head, stays plastic. At the end of each session the hidden state entering layer $k{+}1$ is captured for 50 training documents of that session (the first 50 of the shuffled loader), from the same frozen layers that will produce it forever after, so a stored activation cannot go stale. Each document's activation matrix $H_j \in \mathbb{R}^{709\times768}$ is factorised by a truncated SVD and kept as $(U_r\Sigma_r) \in \mathbb{R}^{709\times r}$ and $V_r^\top \in \mathbb{R}^{r\times768}$ in fp16, together with the document's boxes, attention mask and labels (and, for SBR, the index of the session that stored it). No raw pixels and no token ids are kept.

Table 3. **Where the old-session errors go** (final model, sessions 1 to 4; range over the clean seeds; drawn in Fig. 2b of the main paper). Relab.^{r}: older stored documents relabelled (H1); No mem.: blocked readout without memory. R, P: old-session spans (P overstated; an upper bound under the shared softmax). O^i: missed spans entirely at "O", a span-level indicator, not a bound. Owner to false: per-token routing of old entity tokens; "same" includes B/I swaps. Definitions: the paragraph above. Generated.

	Shared softmax			Blocked readout		
	Naive	CoLaR	Relab.^{r}	No mem.	CoLaR-SBR	SBR-Recall
n	3	3	3	3	3	3
R	0.0	18.7–22.6	71.5–77.3	0.4–13.2	88.4–92.6	92.7–94.0
P		72.8–80.8	86.3–88.2	3.4–10.7	84.8–90.4	90.4–93.2
O^i	98.2–99.4	89.6–94.3	64.2–68.2			
owner				10.6–17.6	95.4–98.3	97.0–98.3
→O				0.0	4.9–6.2	4.4–28.4
→same				6.5–16.2	56.6–71.6	51.1–65.2
→other				83.8–93.5	22.3–38.4	20.0–30.4
false				17.0–24.3	0.6–1.7	0.4–0.8

Table 4. **Session-restricted AA and full-label F1 of the same final model**, every clean-protocol CIL-CORD run on disk that records both (LayoutLMv3 unless the row names another backbone; smoke runs and prediction-dump re-runs excluded; generated).

Scenario	Method	Seed	AA	Full-label F1	Difference
CIL-CORD	CoLaR	42	33.6	32.4	−1.2
CIL-CORD	CoLaR	7	32.4	30.5	−1.9
CIL-CORD	CoLaR	123	34.4	29.3	−5.1
CIL-CORD	Older stored documents relabelled at each boundary (not deployable)	42	65.8	79.1	+13.3
CIL-CORD	Older stored documents relabelled at each boundary (not deployable)	7	62.8	74.9	+12.1
CIL-CORD	Older stored documents relabelled at each boundary (not deployable)	123	62.4	75.4	+13.1
CIL-CORD	CoLaR-SBR	42	87.8	88.8	+1.1
CIL-CORD	CoLaR-SBR	7	91.3	91.2	−0.1
CIL-CORD	CoLaR-SBR	123	86.2	87.1	+1.0
CIL-CORD	SBR, no memory	42	21.2	9.0	−12.3
CIL-CORD	SBR, no memory	7	19.6	11.7	−7.9
CIL-CORD	SBR, no memory	123	24.0	13.6	−10.3
CIL-CORD	SBR-Recall	42	91.4	91.5	+0.2
CIL-CORD	SBR-Recall	7	92.6	93.5	+0.9
CIL-CORD	SBR-Recall	123	91.9	92.6	+0.8
CIL-CORD	Joint training	42	91.1	91.7	+0.6
CIL-CORD	Joint training	7	90.5	91.8	+1.3
CIL-CORD	Joint training	123	92.1	92.4	+0.3
CIL-CORD	Naive	42	18.8	13.2	−5.6
CIL-CORD	Naive	7	18.3	12.8	−5.5
CIL-CORD	Naive	123	17.8	13.0	−4.8

Replay. At every training step four stored documents are sampled uniformly, $\hat{H}_j = (U_r\Sigma_r)V_r^\top$ is rebuilt, and a forward pre-hook on layer $k{+}1$ replaces the hidden state of a dummy input by $\hat{H}_j$; the stored boxes and mask drive the layout position biases and the attention mask of the replayed pass. The loss is the cross-entropy of the current batch plus the cross-entropy of the replayed documents with their stored labels, with weight 1. Gradient checkpointing is switched off for the replayed pass, because recomputation would re-run layer $k{+}1$ on the dummy input.

Memory accounting. The method's memory is counted, per stored document, as the two fp16 factors, $2r(709{+}768)$ bytes (378,112 at $r{=}128$), and the boxes, mask and labels at the eight bytes per entry in which they are held (24,576 bytes); SBR adds one byte for the session index. A document therefore costs 402,689 bytes in CoLaR-SBR, and the 250 documents of CIL-CORD give the 100,672,250 bytes recorded in every CoLaR-SBR run (100.7 MB; 1 MB $= 10^6$ bytes), against 272.3 MB for the same activations uncompressed (training log). These are the figures the paper reports. The implementation's stored record is about 1% larger: on CIL-CORD and Mixed it also holds the document's labels in the *final* label space (4,096 bytes), which include classes of sessions not yet seen and which a continual learner could not have, plus two small integer fields. No method in the paper reads this field; only the true-label refresh diagnostic of Appendix E does, and a deployment would not store it. As held, a record is 406,800 bytes against 402,689 counted: 101.7 against 100.7 MB for the 250 documents of CIL-CORD and 122.0 against 120.8 MB for the 300 of Mixed. DIL is unaffected, and so is SBR-Recall without a memory, whose bytes are deltas.

C.2. SBR

Blocks. A block is created by every session that introduces at least one tag not yet covered by a block; it holds those new tags $\mathcal{T}_b$, a background logit $o_b = w_b^\top h + c_b$ (a linear layer with bias from the 768-dimensional head input to one logit) and the schema of its session. A session that only re-annotates known tags (every DIL session after the first, the Mixed FUNSD revisit) creates no block, so on DIL SBR has exactly one block and differs from CoLaR only in its separate background logit and the thresholded decision. The tag logits z are the rows of the one shared linear head.

The supervision rule. For a document of session s with tag set $\mathcal{A}_s$ and schema d_s, the supervision rule assigns every existing block b one of three modes:

- **full** if $\mathcal{T}_b \subseteq \mathcal{A}_s$: session s annotates every tag of the block, so its "O" labels are true negatives for that block; the target is y for tags of $\mathcal{T}_b$ and O_b for every other token, including annotated entities of other blocks;

Table 5. **Supervision plan** of a document of session s (rows) for block b (columns): F = full, N = all-background, – = skipped. Derived from the supervision rule in the code; the plan of each current session is also printed in the training logs of CoLaR-SBR on CIL-CORD and Mixed and matches. Entries for blocks created after session s apply when s's stored documents are replayed.

CIL-CORD						Mixed					
$s\backslash b$	1	2	3	4	5	$s\backslash b$	1	2	3	4	5
1	F	–	–	–	–	1 FUNSD	F	–	N	N	N
2	–	F	–	–	–	2 FUNSD	–	F	N	N	N
3	–	–	F	–	–	3 SROIE	N	N	F	N	N
4	–	–	–	F	–	4 CORD	N	N	N	F	–
5	–	–	–	–	F	5 CORD	N	N	N	–	F
						6 FUNSD	F	F	N	N	N

- **all-background** if $d_b \neq d_s$: the block belongs to another annotation schema. The document is annotated under its own schema, so no token carries a tag of b, and every token's target is O_b. This is a convention that uses each session's annotation schema at training time, not a fact about the document: across related schemas it can label a real entity of the other schema as background (SROIE and CORD are both receipt schemas and share entity kinds such as totals and dates), and Mixed is the scenario where this matters;
- **skipped** otherwise: same schema, block not annotated, so the document's "O" says nothing about it.

A stored document is supervised by the plan of the session that stored it, evaluated over the blocks that exist when it is replayed. Tab. 5 spells the plans out. On CIL-CORD every session has the same schema, so a document trains only its own block and the all-background mode never occurs. On Mixed the all-background mode is what keeps a block from claiming tokens of another dataset. An earlier version that created a block for every session and had no all-background mode failed on DIL exactly there: the SROIE session reached 23.6 F1 on its own diagonal, because the FUNSD block, never trained on receipts, claimed receipt tokens (one seed, AA 66.5).

Inference. For each token every block reports $e_b = 1 - p_b(\mathrm{O}_b \mid x)$; the block with the largest e_b labels the token with its most probable tag if $e_b > \tau$ (τ=0.5), and the token is "O" otherwise (ties go to the lower block index):

$$\hat{y}(x) = \begin{cases} \arg\max_{t \in \mathcal{T}_{b^\star}} p_{b^\star}(t \mid x) & e_{b^\star} > \tau, \\ \mathrm{O} & \text{otherwise,} \end{cases} \qquad (1)$$

$$b^\star = \arg\max_b e_b.$$

Algorithm 1 CoLaR-SBR: one session s (tags $\mathcal{A}_s$, schema d_s)

$\mathcal{N} \leftarrow \mathcal{A}_s \setminus \bigcup_b \mathcal{T}_b$
if $\mathcal{N} \neq \emptyset$ **then** add block ($\mathcal{T} = \mathcal{N}$, w, d_s)
end if
hold out 10% of the session's training pool
for epoch = 1..10, until early stopping **do**
  for each minibatch X of session s **do**
    $\mathcal{L} \leftarrow \sum_{(b,\mathrm{mode}) \in \mathrm{plan}(s)} \mathrm{CE}_b(X, \mathrm{mode})$
    sample 4 stored documents; rebuild $\hat{H} = (U_r \Sigma_r) V_r^\top$
    inject $\hat{H}$ at layer k+1; for each, add $\sum_{\mathrm{plan}(s')} \mathrm{CE}_b$ of its session s' (mean over the four) to $\mathcal{L}$
    AdamW step on layers k+1..12 (session 1: all layers), head, all w_b
  end for
end for
restore the best weights; **if** $s = 1$: freeze embeddings and layers 1..k
store 50 documents: $(U_r \Sigma_r, V_r^\top)$, boxes, mask, labels, s

No task identity is used, and the session restriction of the evaluation is applied only after this decision.

C.3. SBR-Recall

Deltas. Every linear layer named query, key, value or dense in layers k+1..12 is wrapped by a module that holds one low-rank pair (A_b, B_b) per delta and adds $\frac{\alpha}{r}\, x A_b^\top B_b^\top$ to the base output when delta b is active. "Dense" covers the attention output projection and both feed-forward layers, so a layer carries six deltas and the eight layers above k=4 carry 48. A is initialised Kaiming-uniform and B at zero, so a fresh delta is the identity. The headline setting is rank 64, α=128; the capacity ablation uses rank 8, α=16 on query, key and value only.

Which delta a session trains. The first session trains the base network itself; afterwards the whole encoder is frozen (θ_0) and only the head, the background weights and the current delta are trainable. A session that creates a block gets a fresh delta; a session that creates none reuses the delta of the first block it trains fully (on the Mixed revisit this is the base of the first session, so that session trains only the readout).

Losses under the delta a block is read under. The loss groups the blocks of a document's plan by the delta each block is read under, runs one forward pass per distinct delta, and computes each block's term from the pass under its own delta. Frozen deltas add only the head to the autograd graph. Stored documents, when there is a memory, are grouped by session and pass through the layer-k injection under each delta in the same way. An earlier implementation computed the all-background terms of other-schema blocks under the

current delta, which trained those blocks' readout on features from a trunk state they are never read under; its Mixed run (rank 64, seed 42) is an implementation error, not a result, and is not reported. CIL-CORD has a single schema, so its runs never contain such terms and are unaffected. Algorithm 2 summarises training and inference.

What "cannot drift" means. Without a memory on a single-schema stream, a later session's loss contains only its own block, so an old block's base and delta are frozen, its background weights w_b, c_b are outside the graph, and its rows of the shared tag head receive a zero gradient. Two effects remain. AdamW's decoupled weight decay still shrinks those rows, by under 1% over a run ($5{\times}10^{-7}$ per step for at most ten epochs of four sessions). And each old block's e_b is unchanged, but the arg-max over blocks is not: a new block can out-claim an old one on some tokens. In the legacy rank-64 runs this moves the final F1 of an old session by about a point in either direction (Tab. 10); in the clean rank-64 runs no session falls more than 0.6 points below its diagonal at any later boundary and none rises more than 2.1.

Inference and cost. One forward pass per distinct delta produces the logits of the blocks read under it, and Eq. (1) combines them. Our implementation repeats the full forward pass for each delta: five passes on CIL-CORD (base plus four deltas). Since the embeddings and layers $1..k$ are identical in all of them, a cached implementation repeats only the $12-k$ upper layers, $(k+5(12-k))/12 \approx 3.7$ encoder-layer equivalents of one forward pass at $k{=}4$.

Parameters and memory. A rank-64 delta has $8 \times [3 \cdot 64 \cdot (768{+}768) + 64 \cdot (768{+}768) + 2 \cdot 64 \cdot (768{+}3072)] = 7{,}077{,}888$ parameters; We report the deltas at two bytes per parameter, that is, as if stored in half precision: the four deltas of CIL-CORD give 56,623,104 bytes (57 MB), as recorded in every rank-64 run. This is a reporting choice. The deltas were trained and evaluated in fp32 (113 MB), and no run evaluated half-precision-rounded deltas. A rank-8 delta on query, key and value has 294,912 parameters (2.4 MB for four). With the 50-document memory on Mixed the run records 177.4 MB counted, the deltas plus the CoLaR store (178.7 MB as held).

Algorithm 2 SBR-Recall: what changes relative to Algorithm 1

1: **if** $s = 1$ **then** train the base as in Algorithm 1; then freeze the encoder (θ_0)
2: **else if** session s adds a block **then** create Δ_s ($B{=}0$); trainable: Δ_s, head, w_b
3: **else** reuse the delta of the first block s trains fully
4: **end if**
5: **loss:** for each distinct delta Δ among the plan's blocks, forward X under $\theta_0{+}\Delta$ and add the CE of every block read under Δ
6: **inference:** forward under each distinct delta; block b uses the pass under its own delta; decide by Eq. (1)

D. Extended results

D.1. Retention matrices

Tab. 6 gives $R[i, j]$, the F1 on session j after training session i, averaged over the seeds named in each title; the sources follow the same rule as the main tables, so a matrix moves to the clean protocol with its table cell. The matrices are the numbers behind the retention figure of the main paper; the figures in this paragraph are computed from the mean matrices shown, so they follow the table when its source changes. With a shared softmax the curves fall steeply and irregularly: the first session loses 22 points at the next boundary, the later sessions are learned only to 8 to 26 F1 on their own diagonal, and columns are not monotone afterwards (a column rises by up to 31 points at a later boundary). With the blocked readout every session is learned: CoLaR-SBR and SBR without a memory, which share CoLaR's freezing of the embeddings and layers $1..4$ after the first session, learn every session to at least 81.1 F1 on its own diagonal on every seed (rung H0 of the main paper); from its diagonal to the final row a column loses 2 to 9 points on the mean, session 2 the most. Under SBR-Recall every column of the mean matrix ends within 1.4 points of its diagonal. On Mixed, in the runs shown, CoLaR-SBR keeps every session close to its diagonal and the FUNSD sessions rise again at the revisit.

D.2. Per-seed values behind the headline cells

Tab. 7 lists, for every cell of the main comparison and of the $2{\times}2$, the seeds of the source the cell is read from and the mean training time per run. Every "within", "at" and "on par" statement in the main paper is checked against these per-seed values, not against the mean.

D.3. Stacking LexSlot on CoLaR-SBR

LexSlot adds extra head slots that a session updates only when the OCR vocabulary of its documents selects them; it stores the token ids of its documents, unlike CoLaR. LexSlot exists only as fp32 gate runs, so Tab. 8 compares it with the CoLaR-SBR gate runs of the same protocol, never with the main-table source. Stacked on CoLaR-SBR it moves the per-seed AA by a few points in either direction and leaves the mean within two points on every scenario, and it narrows the spread between seeds on CIL-CORD ($88.0{\pm}2.0$ against $89.7{\pm}0.5$) and DIL ($86.2{\pm}1.3$ against $87.0{\pm}0.4$). It stays below SBR-Recall on CIL-CORD on every seed, against both the gate and the clean SBR-Recall runs. We read it as a second partition of the same readout that SBR already partitions, and keep it as a row, not a method.

Table 6. **Retention matrices** $R[i, j]$ (row i: after training session i; column j: session j; session-restricted scoring, LayoutLMv3), mean over the seeds in each title; †: legacy protocol (Tab. 22). Generated.

CoLaR, shared softmax, CIL-CORD (seeds 42/7/123, clean)

$i\backslash j$	1	2	3	4	5
1	93.9				
2	72.3	70.8			
3	42.2	73.6	25.8		
4	29.7	69.3	57.2	8.4	
5	20.9	59.2	43.3	34.8	9.2

CoLaR-SBR, CIL-CORD (seeds 42/7/123, clean)

$i\backslash j$	1	2	3	4	5
1	93.9				
2	93.7	92.3			
3	91.7	88.4	89.5		
4	91.0	86.8	90.1	89.3	
5	90.8	83.4	87.9	86.2	93.8

SBR-Recall, CIL-CORD (seeds 42/7/123, clean)

$i\backslash j$	1	2	3	4	5
1	93.9				
2	94.1	88.4			
3	94.1	89.2	92.1		
4	94.1	89.7	92.3	89.3	
5	94.1	89.7	92.3	89.1	94.5

CoLaR-SBR, Mixed (seeds 42/7, rescore†)

$i\backslash j$	1	2	3	4	5	6
1	86.2					
2	87.0	90.7				
3	86.5	88.7	82.3			
4	85.0	86.2	79.6	96.3		
5	85.4	90.0	78.6	95.4	96.0	
6	89.6	91.6	77.9	95.1	93.6	90.4

D.4. SBR-Recall on the mixed stream

Three Mixed runs of SBR-Recall exist, all rank 64 and seed 42. The first computed the cross-schema terms under the wrong delta (Appendix C.3) and is not a result. The second is the corrected method without a memory; the third adds the 50-document CoLaR memory. Their matrices are in Tab. 9.

Without a memory the blocks see-saw. Read the no-memory matrix by columns. FUNSD sessions 1 and 2 are learned (87.6, 90.8) and fall to 0.0 as soon as SROIE arrives in session 3; SROIE is learned (82.0) and falls below 10 when CORD arrives; both CORD sessions hold (95.8, 95.5) until the FUNSD revisit, when FUNSD returns (87.3, 85.6) and SROIE and the CORD blocks fall to 8.1 or below. The mechanism is the all-background mode. On a current document of another schema every old block is trained towards O_b on every token, and without stored documents nothing trains it towards its own tags, so its background logit wins and the block stops claiming tokens. The trunk is frozen and the old deltas are not updated, so this is a readout effect, not drift: the readout rows and background weights of the old blocks are shared across deltas and are moved by these terms. When a block's own schema returns, it is supervised fully again and recovers within one session.

With the memory the see-saw disappears. Stored documents supply the positive counterweight: in the with-memory matrix no column falls to zero, the CORD blocks hold above 96, and the run reaches 85.9. The weakest cell is FUNSD session 2 (46–48 through the SROIE and CORD sessions, 75.0 after the revisit). Across schemas, isolation by deltas does not replace the memory, and CoLaR-SBR (89.7 in the main table) remains the better method on Mixed; one seed.

D.5. Delta capacity

Tab. 10 gives the diagonal and the final row of every SBR-Recall capacity run on CIL-CORD. Without a memory the final row is within 1.5 points of the diagonal at either rank, so isolation retains what was learned. At rank 8 on query, key and value, however, sessions 3 and 4 (the sub-total and total fields, mostly prices) are learned only to between 61 and 68 F1 on the diagonal, and adding the memory does not help (AA 80.5 against 82.5). At rank 64 with the attention output and feed-forward layers added, those two diagonals reach 88.8 to 96.2 on all three seeds. Isolation was sound at rank 8; the capacity of the delta was the limit. We adopted rank 64 with the feed-forward layers from these legacy runs, which early-stopped on the test split, before the clean re-runs; it is the one setting chosen on CIL-CORD. All rows of Tab. 10

Table 7. **Per-seed AA of every headline cell** (LayoutLMv3; session-restricted scoring on CIL-CORD and Mixed). Source: clean = clean-protocol runs; gate = fp32 runs of our methods and controls; rescore = re-runs of the baselines on CIL-CORD and Mixed and of CoLaR on Mixed; grid = our earlier grid; †: legacy protocol (settings per row in Tab. 22). ^{c}: an fp16 run that collapsed to all-background, excluded from the LwF mean. h/run: mean training-loop time per run, recorded by each run; precision and hardware differ between groups, so the column is a record, not a cost comparison. Generated.

Row	Source	42	7	123	h/run
CIL-CORD					
Naive	clean	18.8	18.3	17.8	1.3
SBR, no memory	clean	21.2	19.6	24.0	1.2
CoLaR	clean	33.6	32.4	34.4	1.6
CoLaR-SBR	clean	87.8	91.3	86.2	2.1
SBR-Recall	clean	91.4	92.6	91.9	1.6
Joint training	clean	91.1	90.5	92.1	0.3
ER	rescore†	26.9	22.0	24.0	3.4
CoLaR-SBR + LexSlot	gate†	90.2	89.7	89.2	2.3
LwF	rescore†	18.4	18.5	0.0^{c}	1.3
DER++	rescore†	21.3	18.8	21.1	8.2
CODA-Prompt	rescore†	14.0	15.9	–	4.0
CL-LoRA (2025)	rescore†	18.7	18.6	–	3.0
CPFD (2023)	rescore†	2.7	0.0	–	1.0
IS3 (2024)	rescore†	5.6	7.7	–	2.2
LCA (2026)	rescore†	13.7	7.0	–	1.6
Mixed					
Naive	rescore†	44.4	43.7	–	0.7
CoLaR	rescore†	75.6	74.6	–	1.5
CoLaR-SBR	rescore†	89.8	89.6	–	1.4
Joint training	rescore†	86.9	88.5	–	0.8
ER	rescore†	75.6	73.3	–	2.8
CoLaR-SBR + LexSlot	gate†	88.5	90.0	90.3	2.5
SBR-Recall	gate†	85.9	–	–	5.9
LwF	rescore†	47.7	0.0^{c}	–	1.1
DER++	rescore†	75.1	74.0	–	4.3
CODA-Prompt	rescore†	12.1	10.6	–	4.4
CL-LoRA (2025)	rescore†	45.7	43.9	–	2.2
CPFD (2023)	rescore†	0.3	15.1	–	0.8
IS3 (2024)	rescore†	0.0	40.6	–	1.6
LCA (2026)	rescore†	38.0	36.4	–	1.3
DIL					
Naive	grid†	40.1	43.0	40.9	0.5
CoLaR	grid†	87.6	88.3	87.4	1.5
CoLaR-SBR	gate†	86.8	84.8	87.1	1.5
Joint training	grid†	89.7	89.0	87.5	0.3
ER	grid†	86.2	88.7	88.6	0.2
CoLaR-SBR + LexSlot	gate†	87.2	87.2	86.6	1.4
LwF	grid†	42.5	44.6	43.8	0.3
DER++	grid†	88.2	87.1	88.8	0.2
CODA-Prompt	grid†	33.4	31.1	33.0	2.2
CL-LoRA (2025)	grid†	40.8	41.3	41.3	1.6
CPFD (2023)	grid†	0.0	4.2	14.2	0.8
IS3 (2024)	grid†	38.3	–	–	1.2
LCA (2026)	grid†	46.4	43.8	41.5	1.0

are legacy gate runs, so the comparison stays within one protocol; the clean rank-64 runs of the main tables (mean matrix in Tab. 6) also learn sessions 3 and 4.

Table 8. **CoLaR-SBR / + LexSlot (difference)**, AA per seed; both sides are fp32 gate runs† (one protocol per row; Mixed CoLaR-SBR has one gate seed). Generated.

Scenario	Protocol	42	7	123
CIL-CORD	gate†	87.6 / 90.2 (+2.5)	86.3 / 89.7 (+3.5)	90.1 / 89.2 (−0.9)
Mixed	gate†	89.7 / 88.5 (−1.2)	– / 90.0	– / 90.3
DIL	gate†	86.8 / 87.2 (+0.5)	84.8 / 87.2 (+2.5)	87.1 / 86.6 (−0.5)

Table 9. **SBR-Recall on Mixed** (rank 64, seed 42, fp32 gate runs†; session-restricted scoring), without and with the 50-document memory. Sessions as in Tab. 2. Generated.

SBR-Recall, Mixed, no memory (seed 42, gate†)

$i \backslash j$	1	2	3	4	5	6
1	87.6					
2	87.6	90.8				
3	0.0	0.0	82.0			
4	1.6	0.0	9.9	95.8		
5	0.2	0.0	7.7	95.8	95.5	
6	87.3	85.6	0.3	8.1	0.0	86.6

SBR-Recall, Mixed, 50-document memory (seed 42, gate†)

$i \backslash j$	1	2	3	4	5	6
1	87.6					
2	89.0	89.8				
3	78.3	46.2	81.2			
4	80.3	46.6	79.1	96.7		
5	79.1	47.9	79.2	97.0	97.7	
6	85.8	75.0	79.0	96.9	97.3	81.6

E. Analysis of the background conflict

Takeaway. Repairs that change only the labels the memory and the current documents supervise move CIL-CORD AA from 33.5 (CoLaR) to at most 69.3 on any seed without changing what the memory stores; a session-blocked readout with the same memory moves it to 88.4; and the readout without a memory, or on an almost frozen trunk (only the last layer and the readout plastic), does not. The conflict is in the labels, and its remedy is in the readout. Tab. 11 lists the runs with their seeds.

The memory × readout factorial. Tab. 12 gives the four cells of the factorial that the main paper's ladder (its Tab. 1) lists as rows, and Fig. 2 draws them with SBR-Recall and a schematic of the two readouts; both were in the main body before the restructure.

The conflict on one receipt. Fig. 1 of the main paper draws it on look-alike prices. The refresh of rung H1 removes the stored pull for documents stored before the last boundary; the current documents keep theirs. Under SBR

Table 10. **SBR-Recall delta capacity on CIL-CORD** (fp32 gate runs†, 10-epoch cap, test-split early stopping, session-restricted scoring): diagonal $R[j,j]$ (each session when learned), final row $R[5,j]$ and AA. Generated.

		Diagonal $R[j,j]$					Final row $R[5,j]$					
Delta	Seed	1	2	3	4	5	1	2	3	4	5	AA
rank 8, Q/K/V, memory	42†	95.3	92.1	61.5	68.0	88.2	95.4	90.5	63.2	65.1	88.2	80.5
rank 8, Q/K/V, no memory	42†	95.3	91.6	64.9	67.7	90.3	95.4	91.9	66.4	68.4	90.3	82.5
rank 64, Q/K/V + dense, no memory	42†	95.3	92.2	91.6	88.8	93.3	95.4	93.2	92.2	89.3	93.3	92.7
rank 64, Q/K/V + dense, no memory	7†	92.0	92.8	93.5	93.1	93.7	92.4	92.8	94.8	93.1	93.7	93.4
rank 64, Q/K/V + dense, no memory	123†	95.4	89.8	96.2	89.4	91.8	95.5	90.4	95.8	88.6	91.8	92.4

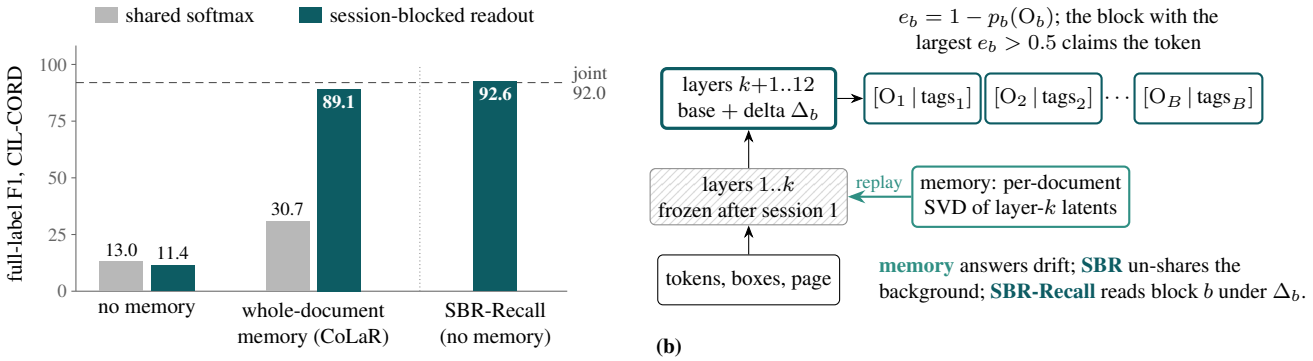


Figure 2. **The memory × readout factorial and the two readouts.** (a) CIL-CORD, LayoutLMv3, full-label F1 (mean of three clean seeds; AA and per-seed values in Tabs. 7 and 12). Left: a whole-document memory alone and a session-blocked readout alone stay far below joint training (dashed), together they close most of the gap. Right: SBR-Recall replaces the memory with one low-rank trunk delta per session. (b) The memory replays per-document SVDs of layer-k activations; SBR gives each session its own background logit and routes tokens without task identity; SBR-Recall reads block b under delta Δ_b.

Table 11. **Controls that separate the label conflict from the memory** (CIL-CORD, LayoutLMv3, CoLaR memory with k=4, r=128, 50 documents per session unless stated; session-restricted scoring; AA per seed). Sliced: the cross-entropy is restricted to {O} and the classes that were live when the document was labelled (replay) or that are new (current "O" tokens). Rescore runs are fp16, gate runs fp32 (Tab. 22); clean rows are clean protocol. Generated.

Row	Source	42	7	123	h/run
CoLaR, shared softmax	clean	33.6	32.4	34.4	1.6
CoLaR, shared softmax (gate run)	gate†	34.1	–	–	2.0
Replay loss sliced to classes alive at storage	rescore†	44.2	39.8	–	1.4
Replay loss sliced (gate run)	gate†	39.4	–	–	1.9
Replay and current losses sliced	gate†	62.9	69.2	49.4	2.3
+ model pseudo-labels written into the memory	gate†	48.0	–	–	2.1
+ pseudo-labels in both directions	gate†	44.1	–	–	2.4
Older stored documents relabelled at each boundary (not deployable)	clean	65.8	62.8	62.4	1.6
Older stored documents relabelled (gate run)	gate†	61.2	–	–	2.1
SBR, no memory	clean	21.2	19.6	24.0	1.2
SBR, no memory, layers 1..11 frozen	gate†	14.8	–	–	1.0
CoLaR-SBR	clean	87.8	91.3	86.2	2.1
Joint training (reference)	clean	91.1	90.5	92.1	0.3

the stored receipt trains only block 1 and the current one only block 5.

Stale labels in the memory. A document stored at session t carries "O" on every entity of another session, earlier or later. The true-label refresh gives, at the end of each session, every document stored *before* that session the true labels of all classes seen so far; the documents of the session just finished keep their own labels until the next boundary, and no refresh can cover the session trained next. So while session t trains, its own classes are "O" in every stored document, and the documents banked at session $t-1$ carry only that session's classes. The refresh rewrites many stored tokens: on Mixed, 3120–3307, 2640–2932, 0 and 305–316 tokens at the four refreshes (50, 100, 150 and 200 stored documents; three seeds, earlier grid, legacy scoring). A deployable variant that

Table 12. **Memory × readout on CIL-CORD** (LayoutLMv3; clean protocol, mean ± s.d. over three seeds). Rows: how drift is handled; columns: how the background is supervised. Only the cell with both approaches joint training, under either metric. Generated.

	Shared softmax		**Session-blocked readout**	
	full-label F1	AA	full-label F1	AA
No memory	13.0±0.2	18.3±0.5	11.4±2.3	21.6±2.2
CoLaR memory	30.7±1.5	33.5±1.0	**89.1±2.0**	**88.4±2.6**
Joint training (reference)	full-label F1 92.0±0.4, AA 91.3±0.8			

refreshes with the model's own confident predictions rewrites 0/0/0/84 tokens on seed 42, none on seed 7 and 7/0/0/36 on seed 123 (84 against the 6,076 that the true-label refresh rewrites on seed 42): the model is confident on almost no stale-"O" token, so the pseudo-label refresh is a no-op (falsification ledger, Tab. 15). On CIL-CORD the true-label refresh rewrites 101/760/1461/1402, 66/944/1366/1269 and 74/943/1315/1110 tokens at its four refreshes on seeds 42, 7 and 123 (earlier grid); in each, the first three refreshes act before sessions 3 to 5 and the fourth runs after the last session and changes no training. Under the clean protocol (three seeds) it rewrites 105/1019/1394 tokens before sessions 3 to 5 and 1239 after the last session (seed 42), and reaches on average 76.5 full-label F1 and 63.6 AA, against 30.7 and 33.5 for CoLaR without the refresh and 92.0 and 91.3 for joint training, seed-matched: 72 to 79% of the gap in full-label F1 and 48 to 56% in AA. It stays below CoLaR-SBR on every seed under both metrics. The control that relabels every stored document *before* each session, so that only the current documents stay stale, is the complete version of this refresh. The legacy gate run of seed 42, which early-stopped on the test split, reached 61.2 AA. The refresh is not deployable, since it reads labels that a continual learner never sees.

Why the two metrics disagree on the refresh. In the clean runs sessions 3 to 5 are learned only to 2 to 37 F1 on their own diagonal; sessions 3 and 4 rise to 74 to 88 one session later, when their own documents enter the memory and the older ones carry their labels, and the last session ends at 3.9 to 14.7. The runs do not separate these two contributions. AA weights the five sessions equally, whereas full-label F1 counts entities: the last session holds 8% of the entities of the CORD test set, so its low final F1 costs AA far more than full-label F1.

Stale labels in the current documents. Current documents label every older entity "O". Slicing only the replay loss to the classes alive at storage gives 42.0 on average over two fp16 rescore seeds (39.4 on the fp32 gate run of seed 42); slicing the current loss as well (an "O" token of the current batch is trained only against O and the new classes: the asymmetric cross-entropy of ER-ACE [4], which masks old classes from the softmax of every incoming sample, applied to current "O" tokens only; with the replay loss sliced too, both sides are masked) reaches about 60 on average over three seeds, with a 20-point spread between seeds. Adding pseudo-labels on top, in one direction or both, does not help (48.0 and 44.1, one seed each). Each of these acts on the shared background logit, and each leaves it pulled in two directions on look-alike price fields.

Table 13. **Drift and its remedy on four encoders** (DIL, AA, mean ± s.d., three seeds; all cells from our first grid, legacy protocol, Tab. 22). On average, replay comes within one point of joint training or exceeds it, and EWC and LwF stay within ten points of naive training. "–": did not fit the 6 GB GPU. Generated; this table was in the main body before the restructure.

Backbone	Naive	EWC	LwF	ER	DER++	Joint
LayoutLMv3	41.3±1.5	41.2±1.1	43.7±1.1	87.9±1.4	88.0±0.9	88.7±1.1
LiLT	40.1±0.5	48.4±5.9	–	85.7±0.5	84.4±0.3	83.8±1.2
BROS	40.3±1.8	45.0±4.9	35.1±3.1	87.8±0.4	87.5±1.1	87.5±1.3
BERT	39.4±0.3	46.6±3.0	40.5±0.1	77.1±0.9	77.4±0.6	77.2±0.4

The readout without the memory, and the memory without plasticity. SBR without a memory scores 21.6±2.2 (three clean seeds) and 11.4±2.3 full-label F1: the labels are consistent within each block, but the trunk drifts and every old session ends at or below 15 F1 after the last session, on every seed (Tab. 11 gives the AA per seed). With every encoder layer but the last frozen after the first session and no memory, SBR scores 14.8 (one seed): sessions 3 to 5 are learned poorly or not at all (4.3, 22.0 and 0.0 on the diagonal) while session 2 is learned at 87.0 on the same trunk. A likely reading is that old blocks out-vote the new ones on surface-identical prices unless the trunk can adapt; the run does not separate this from a block that cannot fit on an almost frozen trunk (only the last layer and the readout plastic). Both plasticity and the memory are needed, and the blocked readout is what lets them combine.

Readout calibration. What SBR still loses to joint training is not a calibration error of the block competition. On the fp16 rescore run of CoLaR-SBR (CIL-CORD, seed 42, AA 85.2), the best global threshold gives 85.4 and a threshold plus a per-block bias tuned on the test set itself gives 85.8, so calibration is worth at most 0.6 (one seed). On DIL, with one block, tuning the threshold gains at most 0.7 and the test-set oracle at most 1.1. The remaining loss is retention of early sessions (Tab. 6), which SBR-Recall removes.

F. Analysis of drift

F.1. The evidence behind rung H0 (Sec. 4.1 of the main paper)

Takeaway. The main paper states drift briefly, in rung H0, because it is the known cause; this subsection holds the measurements it summarises, including the figure that left the main body.

The collapse, and what is already known. Under naive fine-tuning on FUNSD→CORD→SROIE the first task collapses after one further task (FUNSD 89.1 → 3.3 on LayoutLMv3, 83.9 → 2.1 on LiLT, 88.9 → 6.6 on BROS). That forgetting concentrates in the output-facing layers is known



Figure 3. **Drift is output-facing, and freezing moves it.** Left: linear CKA between checkpoints before and after the second task falls with depth on all four backbones (1.0 = no drift; naive fine-tuning, three seeds). Right: freezing the head and late layers leaves backward transfer unchanged, (a) for any number of frozen layers and (b) on three DIL task orders and a ten-session CIL-CORD stream (seed 42, no memory).

for image classifiers [40]; we replicate it on four document encoders, where weighted displacement also separates the head from the late layers (below). That freezing moves drift rather than removing it is consistent with what Kalb and Beyerer [19] report for domain-incremental segmentation, in the mirror direction: they freeze early layers and the shift moves to later ones; we freeze the head and late layers and it moves to the early ones (one seed; Fig. 3, right). That only old-task supervision of the readout repaired drift holds for token-level documents in our experiments; on images the readout can be repaired from class statistics (Appendix F.8).

Where it sits. Per-token CKA between consecutive checkpoints is 1.00 at the embeddings, 0.78 over the early layers, 0.34 in the middle, 0.25 at the last layer and 0.16 at the classifier, with the same profile on all four backbones. Under LayoutLMv3 modality masks the full, text+layout and text-only models forget comparably (BWT -89.8 and -87.2 over three seeds, -79.1 over the two live text-only seeds); the model without text forgets least (-66.7 over three seeds). Old-task-Fisher-weighted displacement is two to three orders of magnitude larger at the classifier than in any encoder bucket, a ratio inflated by construction; inside the encoder it sits in the early and middle layers (Tab. 14).

Freezing. Freezing the whole network after the first task gives AA 41.1 with BWT 0.0 on DIL: nothing is forgotten and nothing is learned. Freezing only the head and late layers, with the early and middle encoder plastic, gives AA 38.8 and BWT -76.8, the naive level, while early-layer CKA falls from $\approx$1.0 to 0.19 (seed 42).

Methods without old-task supervision. EWC and LwF stay within 12 points of naive training and at least 27 below joint training in every run of Tab. 13. Of the five families we built or ported that keep updating a shared network with no stored old-task targets (Tab. 15), head merging is a no-op (21.6 against 21.9 unmerged at its operating point), merging with realignment reaches 43.9, subspace transfer 39.8, head slots 42.2, and feature-Gaussian replay 66.0 by recovering the densely labelled task only, against 41.3 for naive training and 88 for replay. Where we measured the mechanism, on naive training and LwF, the head's output marginal on old tasks snaps to the just-trained task's marginal (cosine 0.997–0.998, against 0.60 to the old task's own), and classes that are never re-exercised fall to exactly 0.0 F1. Five post-hoc corrections of that marginal, each with a pass bar fixed before the run, recover at most -0.1 AA, because old-class probability mass is $\sim 10^{-6}$.

The size of a remedy's benefit is backbone-dependent; the cause is not. The gap between joint and naive training on Mixed agrees to 2.5 points across the four backbones, whereas the benefit of EWC over naive training spans 17 points and changes sign (-11.9 on LayoutLMv3, -2.6 on LiLT, $+3.5$ on BROS, $+5.2$ on BERT; legacy scoring, Tab. 23, Fig. 5). A single-backbone comparison of methods without old-task supervision can land on either side of zero, which is why Tab. 13 reports four backbones.

Images. On ViT-B/16 image class-incremental learning (CIFAR-100, ImageNet-R; Appendix F.8) a class-conditional Gaussian head (SLCA, 87.5/65.0) beats the same latent memory (80.0/55.1), and a ridge readout refit on the trained trunk reaches 88.3/72.3: there the trunk is intact and only readout statistics are stale. An image carries one label, so a per-class statistic summarises its readout; a document carries one label per token bound to a position, and the Gaussian analogue is null on documents in every form we tried (39.4 as a store).

F.2. Displacement by depth

Takeaway. The classifier is where old-task-weighted parameters move most, but that ratio is inflated by construction; inside the encoder, weighted displacement sits in the early and middle layers, so "late layers" is a statement about representations only.

For a checkpoint pair $(\theta^{(t-1)}, \theta^{(t)})$ and a parameter group g we compute the old-task-Fisher-weighted displacement $D_g = \sum_{\phi \in g} F_\phi^{(t-1)} (\theta_\phi^{(t)} - \theta_\phi^{(t-1)})^2$. Tab. 14 reports it at the first task boundary, mean over the live seeds of each

condition, and Fig. 4 shows the profile. The classifier's D_g is two to three orders of magnitude above the largest encoder bucket on every condition (111× to 1608×). The empirical Fisher of a token classifier is largest at the head whatever the task (0.22 against 0.005 for the next group on LayoutLMv3), so the weighting itself favours the head. The informative part is the encoder-only share: with the head excluded, weighted displacement sits in the early and middle layers on every document encoder and is smallest in the late layers. Representational drift measured by CKA, in contrast, grows with depth because it accumulates. The two instruments agree on the classifier and disagree on the late encoder layers, and the main text claims only what both support.

Table 14. Fisher-weighted displacement at the first task boundary under naive fine-tuning (mean over the n live seeds; a run whose final AA is below 1.0 is dead and excluded, which removes one text-only LayoutLMv3 seed). "Head ratio": classifier D_g over the largest encoder bucket. "Encoder share": each bucket's fraction of the encoder total with the head excluded.

			Encoder share			
Condition	n	Head ratio	input	early	mid	late
LayoutLMv3, full	3	273×	0.03	0.70	0.24	0.03
LayoutLMv3, text+layout	3	361×	0.05	0.65	0.27	0.02
LayoutLMv3, text only	2	801×	0.03	0.34	0.51	0.12
LayoutLMv3, no text	3	247×	0.06	0.80	0.13	0.01
LiLT	3	111×	0.05	0.88	0.06	0.00
BROS	3	738×	0.21	0.37	0.37	0.05
BERT	3	1608×	0.18	0.32	0.36	0.14

F.3. What the significance tests do and do not show

Takeaway. Neither test is evidence for the localisation or for architecture-generality; those rest on the descriptive agreement of the profiles and on the remedy ordering.

Two tests accompanied an earlier version of this analysis and we report them with their limits. (i) A Mann–Whitney test of the classifier against each other parameter group (six samples per group, Bonferroni $\alpha' = 0.0042$) rejects equality against three of twelve groups ($p = 0.0022$) and not against the rest; it was run on per-group Fisher *importance*, which is head-dominant by construction, and we do not use it as evidence of where forgetting occurs. (ii) A permutation test on the normalised D_g depth profile does not reject a shared profile between LayoutLMv3 and LiLT or BROS ($p = 0.38$, 0.51); since every normalised profile is nearly one-hot at the head, this test cannot reject and is not evidence of architecture-generality. The claim that drift is shared across backbones rests on the descriptive agreement of the CKA profiles and of Tab. 14, and on the remedy ordering of Tab. 23.

F.4. Consolidation probe

Takeaway. A uniform depth penalty prevents learning; the probe does not show that a targeted penalty recovers old tasks without replay.

A depth-targeted consolidation method (output distillation with a per-bucket penalty) scores 42.6 AA on DIL when the penalty is spread uniformly over all depth buckets, 84.7 when concentrated on the head and late layers, 86.1 head-only and 86.2 late-only (three seeds). All four arms include a 200-document head-replay buffer, and plain ER with the same buffer scores 87.9. We do not cite the probe for recovery without replay.

F.5. Remedy benefit across backbones

Takeaway. The cause is shared by four encoders; the benefit of a remedy without old-task supervision is not, and can change sign.

Fig. 5 plots, per backbone and scenario, the change in AA over naive training of each classical remedy, from the earlier grid (Tab. 23; legacy scoring on CIL-CORD and Mixed). Replay's benefit is large and consistent; EWC and LwF change sign across backbones, which is why Tab. 13 reports four backbones.

F.6. The falsification ledger

Takeaway. Five families that keep updating a shared network without stored old-task targets were each built in their strongest form we could manage, and each fails for a reason identified per boundary, not inferred from the score.

Tab. 15 lists them with their best AA on DIL and the failure reason; the last row is the label-refresh family of Appendix E.

F.7. What the memory must hold

Takeaway. Whole documents retain and every summary of the same store collapses; each document can then be compressed on its own (Figs. 6 to 8). In the main paper this memory is a component of the experiments, not a contribution; this subsection holds what its body described before the restructure.

Whole documents retain; summaries collapse. To find the least a memory must store we vary the stored object and hold the mechanism fixed: activations are captured at the output of layer k, layers $1..k$ are frozen after the first task, and stored activations are replayed through the plastic upper layers and head (DIL, LayoutLMv3; single-seed diagnostics unless stated). Replaying the stored activations of 50 whole documents per task retains AA 87.3. Summaries of the *same* store collapse to the naive level: a rank-16 pooled spectral summary 41.9, per-class Gaussians 39.4, real k-means centroids 36.7–39.7. A single-variable control isolates the

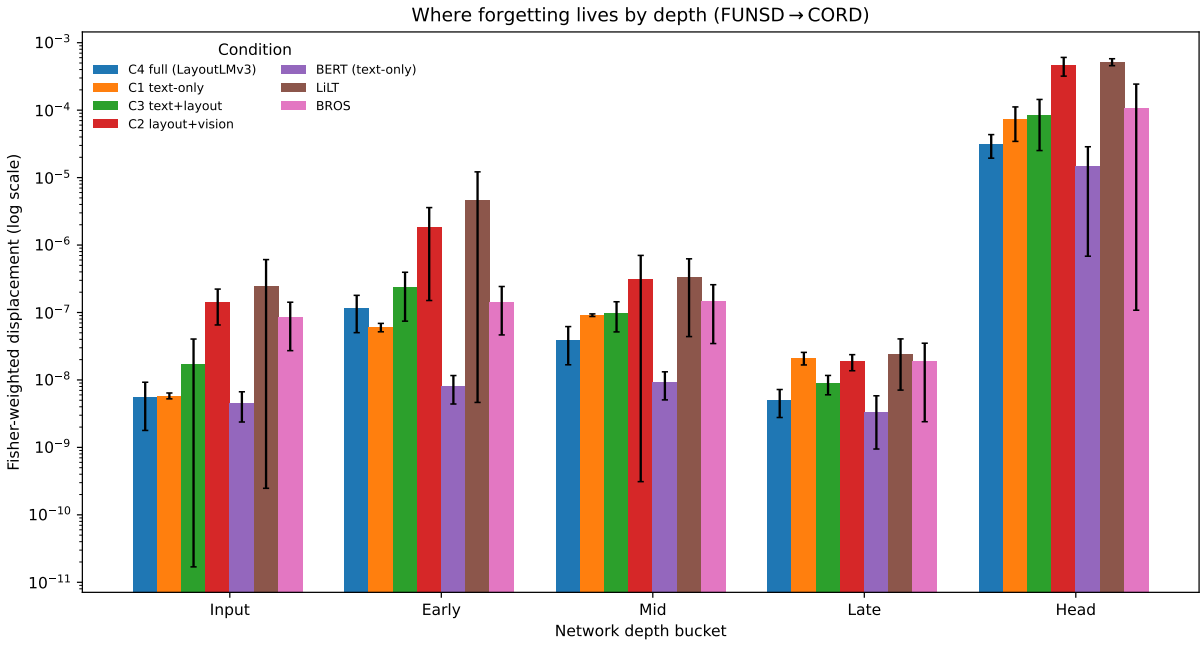


Figure 4. Where forgetting lives. Old-task-Fisher-weighted displacement D_g by depth bucket (log scale, first boundary), for the four LayoutLMv3 modality-mask conditions, text-only BERT, LiLT and BROS; mean over three seeds (two for text-only LayoutLMv3, whose third run is dead and excluded), ± 1 s.d. The classifier head's weighted displacement is two or more orders of magnitude above any encoder layer's on every backbone.

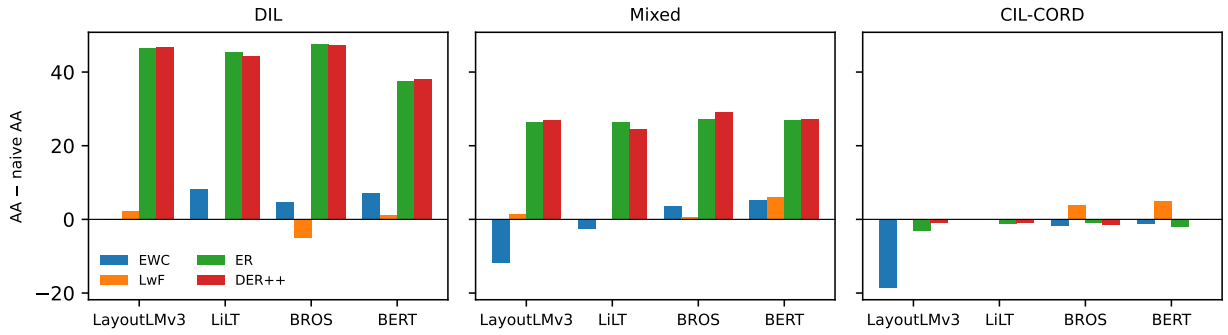


Figure 5. Remedy benefit is backbone-dependent; the phenomenon is not. Change in AA over naive for each classical remedy, per backbone and scenario (mean of three seeds, earlier grid, legacy scoring on CIL-CORD and Mixed). Replay's benefit is large and consistent; EWC and LwF change sign across backbones (missing bars: cells not run).

ingredient: four whole documents retain 63.8, and the identical token features placed on layout carriers from other documents retain 36.7; the binding of a token's feature to its position and its label is worth 27 points. The contrast is not documents against images but where the statistic enters the network. Used at the readout, a class-conditional Gaussian head (SLCA) beats the same latent memory on images (Appendix F.8); injected below the self-attention layers, per-class Gaussians fall to the naive level on images as well (10.7, Appendix F.8); and on documents the readout-level Gaussian realignment we ran, LCA's after merging, reaches only 43.9 on DIL (Tab. 15), though its merge step confounds the comparison.

Per-document compression. The pooled feature space is close to full rank, but one document's tokens share a layout and a vocabulary, so its activation matrix $H_j \in \mathbb{R}^{N_j \times d}$ is low-rank. CoLaR stores a rank-r truncated SVD per document, $H_j \approx U_r \Sigma_r V_r^\top$, with the document's boxes, attention mask and labels, rebuilds $\hat{H}_j$ at replay, and injects it at

Table 15. Falsification ledger, DIL/LayoutLMv3 (naive 41.3, replay ≈ 88). Instance names are ours and belong to the family in the first column; LexSlot selects head slots by OCR-vocabulary overlap, and CoLaR-R is CoLaR with the stored labels refreshed. Each family is the strongest instance we could build of its mechanism; the failure reason is from a per-boundary root-cause analysis, not inferred from the score. †run at a frozen-backbone, short-schedule (3–5 epoch) operating point whose own naive level is given in the cell. ‡CIL-CORD and Mixed, LayoutLMv3, three seeds each, legacy scoring; pseudo = refresh with the model's own predictions, oracle = refresh with the true labels (not deployable).

Family	Instance	Best AA	Why it fails
Weight merging	TIES/Fisher head merge†	21.6 (no-merge 21.9)	merge of head vectors cancels; near no-op
Merge + realignment	LCA (ported)	43.9±2.5	backbone merge halves BWT; Gaussian realignment kills acquisition
Subspace transfer	HGT / CUBER (ported)†	39.8 (own naive 38.7); HGT ≤ 25.3	protected subspace grows; head unconstrained; α is a pure stability–plasticity dial
Parametric slots	LexSlot (no buffer)	42.2	isolated head slots cannot re-ground shared head
Input-anchored memory	Ledger†	FUNSD 21 / SROIE 23	own-vs-cumulative gap is training-free
Feature-Gaussian replay	LexMem v3b (positive control)	66.0	partial: recovers dense-label tasks only
	LexMem v5 (+relational)	63.2; mid-task 13.0	marginal summary breaks doc consistency
Label refresh (latent memory)	CoLaR-R pseudo (CIL-CORD / Mixed, 3 seeds each)‡	20.0 / 59.5 (plain 20.4 / 58.8; oracle 26.3 / 64.4)	teacher confident on ≈ 0 stale-O tokens; pseudo refresh is a no-op on both scenarios (oracle refresh +5.9 / +5.6 shows the slot is reachable only with true labels)

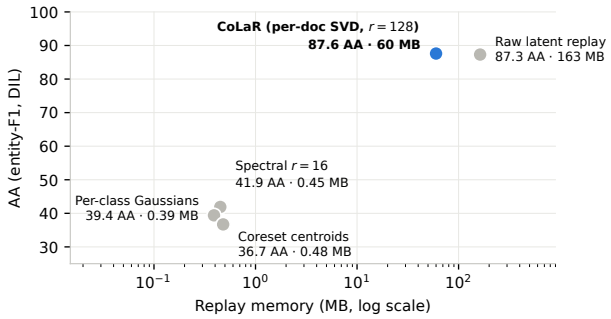


Figure 6. Memory size versus retention (DIL, LayoutLMv3, AA, seed 42; log-scale memory). Per-document SVD (CoLaR) matches raw latent replay at 2.7× less storage; every summary that breaks whole-document binding falls to the naive level.

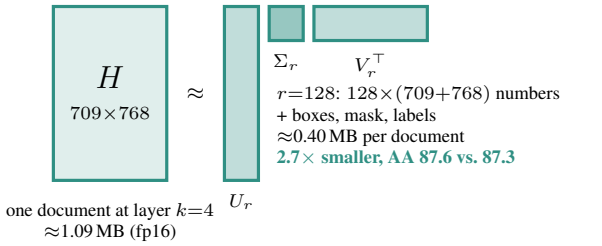


Figure 7. **CoLaR stores whole documents, compressed one at a time.** The pooled layer-k feature space is near full-rank (rank 16 keeps 43% of the variance), but a single document's activations are low-rank: its tokens share one layout and one vocabulary. Sizes for one padded document (512 text and 197 image tokens); AA on DIL, LayoutLMv3, seed 42, against uncompressed latent replay. Truncated SVD per document keeps every token's feature at its own position with its own label, which is the binding that every marginal summary destroys (Fig. 8).

layer k; the loss is cross-entropy on the current batch plus cross-entropy on replayed documents. Per-sequence truncated SVD of transformer activations is an existing format (it compresses key caches); what is ours is its use as a replay memory. At k=4, r=128 and 50 documents per task it retains 87.8±0.5 AA on DIL in 60 MB, against 87.9±1.4 for ER with 200 raw documents and 88.7±1.1 for joint training, and is 2.7× smaller than the uncompressed latent memory it matches (87.3 at about 163 MB; Fig. 6); r=64 gives 80.6 at about 32 MB. These are the settings carried unchanged to every class-incremental stream. Rebalancing the memory does not move AA, and read-side additions lower it (below).

Routing which stored document to replay (null). The OCR vocabulary of a document is set by the input and does not drift with training, which suggests a drift-free sampler: a softmax over term-frequency signature scores $s_j = \sigma(x)^\top \sigma_j$ in three directions (*near*, *far*, *task*), uniform as the zero-point. The seed-42 reading was promising (far +1.8 over uniform 86.4 at d=50), so we fixed that single arm in advance for confirmation. Across three seeds the gap collapses to $+1.8/+0.4/-0.6$, mean +0.5 points with a sign flip, inside the uniform-sampling spread: lexical routing is a null, and the CoLaR results do not depend on it.

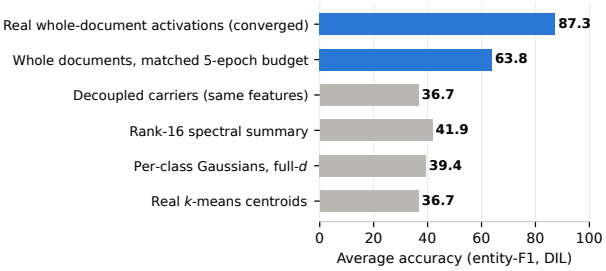


Figure 8. **What the memory must hold** (DIL, LayoutLMv3, layer k=8, AA, single-seed diagnostics). Whole documents retain; summaries of the same store fall to the naive level (41.3), and the identical features on decoupled layout carriers lose 27 points against matched whole documents.

Rebalancing and reading the memory (nulls). On DIL with LayoutLMv3 (CoLaR, k=4, r=128, 50 documents per task; base 87.6 on seed 42), three changes to how the memory is filled or weighted leave AA where it was: a class-balanced replay loss gives 87.1, coverage-based (k-centre) document selection 86.8 and entity-weighted compression 87.1 (seed 42 each). Each trades FUNSD retention

for SROIE retention at about 1:1, so the changes redistribute retention between tasks rather than add to it. A three-seed check finds no lever above the base (class-balanced 87.8, k-centre 87.0, against 87.8±0.5 for the base). Two read-side additions are negative: blending a kNN readout over the stored latents into the head is inert or harmful, and metaplastic consolidation of the readout lowers AA from 85.9 to 79.5 at its own operating point.

Budget-adaptive allocation is a frontier, not a gain. Allocating a fixed compressed-replay budget unevenly across tasks (documents $[18, 5, 2]$, ranks $[64, 128, 64]$ vs. a uniform 10 documents at rank 64; 5 epochs, k=4) gave +4.0 AA on seed 42 while passing a per-domain guard fixed in advance. On seeds 7 and 123 the same comparison gave −8.0 and +5.7: $+0.6 \pm 7.5$ over three seeds, a null. The seed-42 result was a point on a Pareto frontier (old-domain retention traded against the final domain at ≈ 9:1), not a shift of the frontier, and we report it as such.

A bounded positive on the storage side. Replaying pseudo-labelled *public* documents through the same mechanism (zero private bytes) recovers dense-label tasks (FUNSD 76.1) but not one the proxy pool does not cover (SROIE ∼ 7), topping out at 58.9: coverage-limited transfer.

F.8. Image class-incremental learning

Takeaway. On images the ranking inverts: a class-conditional Gaussian head beats the same latent memory, because an image carries one label and its readout is summarised by a per-class statistic; the trunk is intact and the gap is readout coverage.

Tab. 16 gives the fixed comparison set on ViT-B/16 (CIFAR-100, ImageNet-R; ten sessions) and Tab. 17 extends it with BWT and with every image run outside the fixed set that we keep as evidence, all under the same recipe (Appendix H). Two readings matter. Replay at 200 exemplars is far below the 2,000-exemplar rows (42.3/21.6 vs. 76.2/54.8 for ER), so the memory size in Tab. 16 is the one at which replay is competitive, not a favourable choice for our rows. SLCA's whole margin comes from its classifier alignment: without it the same recipe falls to 38.0/25.8, below 200-exemplar replay on CIFAR-100, which is the image-side instance of the head-locus finding. Per-class Gaussian latent replay, the image port of the document-side Gaussian store, sits at the naive level (10.7).

Ridge decomposition of the plastic-head gap. Tab. 18 reports a ridge-readout probe on the trained trunk of our replay rows (seed 42). After the last session the trunk is frozen and a closed-form ridge readout (random projection to 10,000 ReLU features, λ=10, the RanPAC recipe) is fitted under three data conditions: on the stored memory only (deployable), on all training data of all sessions (a non-deployable ceiling on what the features support), and on all data through the frozen pre-trained trunk (image only). Three differences follow: the *head gap* (full ridge minus the trained head) is the total headroom of the readout; the *coverage gap* (full minus stored) is the part that needs features of inputs the memory does not hold; the *trunk gap* (adapted minus frozen) is what replay-driven adaptation bought. On images the head gap is 9.5/16.1 points and is mostly coverage (7.5/14.3), so a better analytic head on the stored latents does not close the gap to SLCA; the adapted trunk is nevertheless 2.9/15.0 points better than the frozen one under the same readout, so adaptation is not the problem. On documents the head gap of CoLaR is within one point on DIL and Mixed and 7.7 points on CIL-CORD with zero coverage gap, i.e. the compressed

Table 16. **Fixed comparison set on image CIL** (ViT-B/16, ten sessions, AA, mean ± s.d., seeds 42/7/123): the same references (naive, joint training) and baselines as the comparison table of the main paper, with SLCA and RanPAC in the slots CPFD and IS3 take on documents. ER/DER++/SLCA keep 2,000 exemplars; the uncompressed latent memory and CoLaR keep 500/class. Ridge is a diagnostic readout refit, not a method.

Method	CIFAR-100	ImageNet-R
Naive	11.7 ± 1.1	9.3 ± 0.3
LwF	15.7 ± 0.6	12.7 ± 1.4
ER (2,000 exemplars)	76.2 ± 1.2	54.8 ± 0.7
DER++ (2,000 exemplars)	76.5 ± 1.5	52.8 ± 1.1
CODA-Prompt	15.2 ± 1.8	8.4 ± 0.7
CL-LoRA (2025)	14.1 ± 1.2	11.4 ± 0.8
SLCA (2023)	87.5 ± 0.2	65.0 ± 0.3
RanPAC (2023)	85.3 ± 0.1	58.5 ± 0.3
LCA (2026)	77.2 ± 3.2	54.7 ± 3.6
Latent memory, 500/class (ours, uncompressed)	80.0 ± 0.7	55.1 ± 1.3
CoLaR r=128, 500/class (ours)	79.5 ± 1.0	55.3 ± 1.4
Ridge readout on the latent-memory trunk (probe, seed 42)	88.3	72.3
Joint training (reference)	89.5 ± 0.4	77.6 ± 0.5

Table 17. Image class-incremental learning, AA and BWT, mean±std over seeds 42/7/123 (ViT-B/16, ten sessions). Fixed comparison set first, our rows, joint training (reference), then the dominated rows kept as evidence. SimpleCIL is a single seed.

	CIFAR-100		ImageNet-R	
Method	AA	BWT	AA	BWT
Naive	11.7 ± 1.1	-95.6 ± 1.4	9.3 ± 0.3	-87.1 ± 0.8
LwF	15.7 ± 0.6	-91.0 ± 0.7	12.7 ± 1.4	-84.4 ± 1.4
ER (2,000 exemplars)	76.2 ± 1.2	-23.8 ± 1.3	54.8 ± 0.7	-37.9 ± 0.9
DER++ (2,000 exemplars)	76.5 ± 1.5	-23.6 ± 1.7	52.8 ± 1.1	-40.5 ± 1.5
CODA-Prompt	15.2 ± 1.8	-89.7 ± 1.9	8.4 ± 0.7	-67.4 ± 1.7
CL-LoRA (2025)	14.1 ± 1.2	-92.7 ± 1.4	11.4 ± 0.8	-82.2 ± 0.8
SLCA (2023)	87.5 ± 0.2	-7.8 ± 0.2	65.0 ± 0.3	-13.5 ± 0.2
RanPAC (2023)	85.3 ± 0.1	-5.0 ± 0.1	58.5 ± 0.3	-7.0 ± 0.3
LCA (2026)	77.2 ± 3.2	-15.8 ± 3.8	54.7 ± 3.6	-21.8 ± 4.6
Latent memory, 500/class (ours, uncompressed)	80.0 ± 0.7	-19.8 ± 0.7	55.1 ± 1.3	-37.4 ± 1.3
CoLaR r=128, 500/class (ours)	79.5 ± 1.0	-20.4 ± 1.1	55.3 ± 1.4	-36.8 ± 1.5
Joint training (reference)	89.5 ± 0.4	–	77.6 ± 0.5	–
EWC	13.9 ± 1.5	-93.1 ± 1.6	9.3 ± 0.2	-87.2 ± 0.1
ER (200 exemplars)	42.3 ± 2.7	-61.6 ± 3.1	21.6 ± 1.3	-75.2 ± 1.4
DER++ (200 exemplars)	43.6 ± 4.0	-60.6 ± 4.2	20.2 ± 2.5	-77.2 ± 2.5
SLCA without classifier alignment	38.0 ± 3.9	-66.7 ± 4.3	25.8 ± 0.7	-67.4 ± 0.9
SimpleCIL (frozen trunk, NCM)	81.7 (1 seed)	-5.5 (1 seed)	48.2 (1 seed)	-6.2 (1 seed)
Per-class Gaussian latent replay (falsified)	10.7 ± 0.8	-96.5 ± 1.0	–	–

Table 18. Ridge decomposition, seed 42, AA (LayoutLMv3 on documents, ViT-B/16 on images). *Head*: the trained plastic head. *Ridge, stored/full/frozen*: closed-form readout on the stored latents, on all seen training data, and on all data through the frozen pre-trained trunk. Gaps as defined in the text; a dash means the condition does not apply (documents have no frozen-trunk reference).

Cell	Head	Ridge, stored	Ridge, full	Ridge, frozen	Head gap	Trunk gap	Coverage gap
CIFAR-100, latent memory	78.8	80.8	88.3	85.4	9.5	2.9	7.5
ImageNet-R, latent memory	56.2	58.0	72.3	57.3	16.1	15.0	14.3
DIL, CoLaR	90.9	91.1	91.3	–	0.3	–	0.2
CIL-CORD, CoLaR	67.5	75.2	75.2	–	7.7	–	0.0
Mixed, CoLaR	70.9	71.0	71.6	–	0.7	–	0.6

store already covers its documents and the residual is the plastic head itself. The probe reads every past training image once at the end and is therefore a diagnostic, not a continual method.

G. Baselines and protocols

Baselines and ports. EWC uses $\lambda{=}10^3$ with the Fisher over 200 documents; LwF $T{=}2$, $\alpha{=}1$; ER and DER++ a reservoir of 200 samples in the legacy cells, DER++ $\alpha{=}\beta{=}0.5$. Our O-LoRA and CL-LoRA ports train a single rank-8 LoRA adapter on the query, key and value projections of the frozen pre-trained encoder, shared by all sessions and retrained in each with an orthogonality penalty ($\lambda{=}0.5$) against its own earlier states; CL-LoRA adds distillation towards the previous model ($T{=}2$); its gradient-reassignment scale was left at 1, which leaves the distillation gradient unchanged. An early version of both ports multiplied the adapter matrices of the penalty in the wrong order; the first-grid LayoutLMv3 runs of O-LoRA (all streams) and of CL-LoRA (DIL, Mixed and CIL-CORD seeds 42 and 7) were made with it, and every table that shows them says so. Our ER with C-Flat++ port was run with its curvature weight at 0 throughout, which makes it ER with SAM, and we name it so. The published designs differ (O-LoRA learns a new adapter per task in an orthogonal subspace; CL-LoRA pairs task-shared with task-specific adapters), so these rows report our ports. CPFD and IS3 are ported onto the single growing token-classification head used by every other method (the reference implementations keep per-task classifiers). LCA merges the backbone with TIES and realigns the classifier with Gaussian feature replay; our port uses the same single growing head (the reference keeps per-task heads) and fits the Gaussians per token class with "O" excluded, and it keeps the published optimiser rather than our AdamW recipe: SGD with momentum 0.9 and a cosine schedule, learning rate 0.01 and weight decay $5{\times}10^{-4}$ for the backbone and head, and SGD at $5{\times}10^{-3}$ for the realignment (our port; the rates are recorded by every LCA run). Tab. 19 collects every baseline in one card.

How the comparison set was fixed. The set (eight published methods from five families) was fixed after a first grid had run these and other methods on all three streams, and after first runs of the kept methods. On that grid's CIL-CORD runs (Tab. 20) EWC, L2P and DualPrompt left at least sessions 4 and 5 unlearned (own diagonal below 1 F1) on every seed, and ER with SAM stayed within 2.8 AA of ER, which was kept. Under that grid's raw scoring every method, ER included, reads below naive training, so the AA columns alone do not rank them. Methods that fail on the scenario (CPFD, IS3) were kept. O-LoRA was dropped too; its runs predate the fix of our port's penalty (above), so we do not report them here. SD-LoRA is implemented but was never run on CIL-CORD, and is not part of the set.

Prompt-, LoRA- and flatness-based baselines. Tab. 21 reports the frozen-backbone prompt family (L2P, DualPrompt, CODA-Prompt), the orthogonal/continual LoRA family and ER with SAM (our C-Flat++ port with its curvature weight at 0) on DIL, three seeds, LayoutLMv3 and BERT. The prompt family forgets little but never acquires the task (AA $\approx$ 30–35, below the naive level of 41.3): a frozen document encoder with a drifting shared head cannot be routed back into place. Our single-adapter LoRA ports acquire but forget as much as naive training does. Only the replay-based variant reaches the level of replay, and SAM adds nothing over plain ER (88.4 vs. 87.9 on LayoutLMv3), consistent with rung H0 of the main paper (Sec. 4.1): the remedy ordering is set by whether the head is re-grounded, not by the optimiser. On CIL-CORD our CL-LoRA port learns each session (81 to 95 F1 on the diagonal in the reruns of the main table) and ends at zero on every session but the last.

Settings of the legacy-protocol cells. Cells marked † come from three groups of earlier runs: the *gate* runs of our methods and controls (fp32), the *rescore* runs of the baselines on CIL-CORD and Mixed and of CoLaR on Mixed (mostly fp16), and our earlier *grid*. They differ from the clean protocol in three ways. First, every legacy cell early-stops on the session's *test* split, except joint training on Mixed, which holds out 10% of its pooled training set. Second, on CIL-CORD and Mixed the epoch cap differs by method: 100 for naive and joint training (Mixed only; their CIL-CORD cells are clean), ER, DER++, LwF, CPFD and IS3, 30 for CODA-Prompt and CL-LoRA, 10 for the CoLaR-family rows and LCA. Third, precision differs: most rescore cells ran in fp16 mixed precision, but IS3 and LCA always ran in fp32 (their training loops never enable autocast), and seed 42 of ER, DER++, LwF, CPFD, CL-LoRA and CODA-Prompt on CIL-CORD ran in fp32 because it started before mixed precision was wired into those loops, so several cells mix precisions across seeds. The CIL-CORD LexSlot cell and the DIL SBR

Table 19. **Baseline card** (the comparison set of the main paper's Tab. 3). Top: venue and family; what our port keeps of the published method and what it changes (read from each method's implementation); what it stores across sessions. Bottom: the hyper-parameters recorded by the CIL-CORD run the comparison table reads (first seed; "epochs": the epoch cap; LCA's lr is its SGD rate, Appendix G); and the protocol and number of seeds behind each cell. Legacy settings per group: Tab. 22. Generated.

Method	Venue	Family	Our port keeps	Our port changes	Memory
ER	NeurIPS 2019	Replay	reservoir buffer replayed in every step	–	200 raw documents
DER++	NeurIPS 2020	Replay	replay of documents with labels and stored logits	–	200 raw documents + logits
LwF	ECCV 2016	Regularisation	distillation of the old logits towards the previous model	–	previous model
CODA-Prompt	CVPR 2023	Prompt, LoRA	attention-weighted prompt components with an orthogonality penalty, frozen encoder	prompts prepended to the input sequence (an input-prepend variant)	none (prompt pool)
CL-LoRA	CVPR 2025	Prompt, LoRA	orthogonality penalty, distillation towards the previous model	one shared rank-8 adapter retrained each session (published: random-orthogonal shared and block-wise task-specific adapters, early-exit distillation); gradient reassignment at scale 1, i.e. off	previous model, past adapter matrices
CPFD	EMNLP 2023	Continual NER	confidence pseudo-labels, logit and attention-map distillation, adaptive CE factor	one growing token head (published: per-task classifiers); sample weights set to 1	previous model
IS3	Findings ACL 2024	Continual NER	distillation on "O" tokens, head-row gradient surgery, prototype replay	one growing token head (published: per-task classifiers)	previous model, class prototypes
LCA	ICLR 2026	Merging	per-session fine-tuning (SGD), TIES backbone merge, Gaussian classifier realignment	one growing token head (published: per-task heads); Gaussians per token class, "O" excluded	base and per-session backbones, class Gaussians

		Protocol, seeds		
Method	Hyper-parameters (recorded, CIL-CORD)	CIL-CORD	Mixed	DIL
ER	buffer_size 200, replay_batch_size 8, epochs 100	legacy†, 3	legacy†, 2	legacy†, 3
DER++	buffer_size 200, alpha 0.5, beta 0.5, epochs 100	legacy†, 3	legacy†, 2	legacy†, 3
LwF	alpha 1.0, temperature 2.0, epochs 100	legacy†, 2	legacy†, 1	legacy†, 3
CODA-Prompt	n_components 10, prompt_length 5, lambda_ortho 0.1, epochs 30	legacy†, 2	legacy†, 2	legacy†, 3
CL-LoRA	lora_rank 8, lora_alpha 16, lambda_ortho 0.5, kd_alpha 1.0, temperature 2.0, shared_grad_scale 1.0, epochs 30	legacy†, 2	legacy†, 2	legacy†, 3
CPFD	distill_weight 2.0, threshold 0.001, epochs 100	legacy†, 2	legacy†, 2	legacy†, 3
IS3	kd_weight 2.0, proto_weight 0.1, grad_weight 0.6, epochs 100	legacy†, 2	legacy†, 2	legacy†, 1
LCA	lr 0.01, merge_method ties, merge_topk 100, ca_epochs 10, ca_samples_per_cls 256, epochs 10	legacy†, 2	legacy†, 2	legacy†, 3

Table 20. **Methods dropped when the comparison set was fixed**: AA per seed on CIL-CORD in the first grid (LayoutLMv3, raw legacy scoring, which reads 33 for joint training and puts every method, ER included, below naive training; App. B), and the sessions whose own diagonal stays below 1 F1, beside naive training and ER from the same grid. The rows ran in two batches whose hyper-parameters were not recorded. Generated.

	AA, seed			Unlearned sessions
Method	42	7	123	(seeds 42 / 7 / 123)
Naive (reference)	18.8	19.1	19.1	none / none / none
ER (kept)	16.9	14.4	16.6	none / none / none
EWC	1.1	0.0	0.3	3–5 / 4–5 / 4–5
L2P	0.0	2.1	1.3	3–5 / 2–5 / 2–5
DualPrompt	0.0	2.0	3.3	3–5 / 2–5 / 2–5
ER with SAM	14.2	16.6	17.0	none / none / none

Table 21. Prompt, LoRA and SAM baselines, DIL, AA and BWT, mean±std over seeds 42/7/123. Naive 41.3 (LayoutLMv3), ER 87.9. ^{p}LayoutLMv3 runs made before we fixed our LoRA ports' orthogonality penalty (Appendix G); the BERT runs came after it.

	LayoutLMv3		BERT	
Method	AA	BWT	AA	BWT
L2P	30.4 ± 0.4	-11.5 ± 0.1	34.4 ± 0.7	-38.5 ± 1.0
DualPrompt	29.9 ± 0.6	-11.1 ± 0.2	34.0 ± 0.2	-40.2 ± 1.1
CODA-Prompt	32.5 ± 1.2	-10.5 ± 0.2	35.2 ± 0.7	-40.7 ± 1.3
O-LoRA^{p}	40.8 ± 0.3	-56.8 ± 1.0	37.4 ± 0.3	-53.4 ± 0.9
CL-LoRA^{p}	41.1 ± 0.3	-58.8 ± 2.1	38.6 ± 0.4	-31.6 ± 1.9
ER with SAM	88.4 ± 0.1	-1.8 ± 0.6	78.3 ± 0.4	-2.2 ± 0.1

cells are fp32 gate runs; every cell of the CIL-CORD 2×2, SBR-Recall and the joint-training reference on CIL-CORD are clean, and the fp32 gate runs of CoLaR-SBR and SBR-Recall appear only in the LexSlot comparison (Tab. 8) and the delta-capacity table (Tab. 10). The first DIL grid saved no configuration; for it Tab. 22 gives the grid script's defaults, which could not be confirmed per run. Tab. 22 lists, for every group of † cells, the epoch cap, numeric precision, memory and seed count, read from each run's log and saved configuration. A cell never combines the two protocols.

Legacy-scored tables. Tabs. 23 and 24 are the tables of the earlier grid. Their CIL-CORD and Mixed columns use legacy scoring, under which joint training reads 33 on CIL-

Table 22. **Settings of the legacy-protocol (†) cells.** Every row early-stops on the session's test split, except joint training on Mixed, which holds out 10% of its pooled training set. Precision "fp32/fp16": seed 42 on CIL-CORD ran in fp32 (mixed precision was added to these training loops only afterwards) and every other seed in fp16 mixed precision. Seeds are given per scenario in the order of the second column. The clean protocol replaces all of this with fp32, a 10-epoch cap (100 for joint training) and early stopping on 10% held out from each session's training data. ‡LwF: the one fp16 seed per scenario that collapsed to zero is excluded (CIL-CORD seed 123, Mixed seed 7), leaving 2 and 1 seeds. *The first DIL grid (naive, EWC, LwF, ER, DER++, CODA-Prompt, CL-LoRA, joint training; all four backbones) saved no configuration; the values are the grid script's defaults and could not be confirmed per run (that script's default batch size was 16, against 2 for every later run), and joint training early-stopped on the pooled test sets. §On CIL-CORD these gate runs feed only the LexSlot comparison (Tab. 8) and the delta-capacity table (Tab. 10); the main-table cells are clean. ‖LCA trains with its published optimiser, SGD at learning rate 0.01 (realignment: 5×10^{-3}), not AdamW at 5×10^{-5} (Appendix G).

Row	Scenarios	Epoch cap	Precision	Memory	Seeds
Naive, joint training	Mixed	100	fp16	none	2
ER, DER++	CIL-CORD, Mixed	100	fp32/fp16	200 samples (reservoir)	3, 2
LwF	CIL-CORD, Mixed	100	fp32/fp16	previous model	3, 2‡
CPFD	CIL-CORD, Mixed	100	fp32/fp16	previous model	2, 2
IS3	CIL-CORD, Mixed	100	fp32	previous model, prototypes	2, 2
CODA-Prompt	CIL-CORD, Mixed	30	fp32/fp16	none	2, 2
CL-LoRA	CIL-CORD, Mixed	30	fp32/fp16	previous model, past adapters	2, 2
LCA‖	CIL-CORD, Mixed	10	fp32	backbones, class Gaussians	2, 2
CoLaR	Mixed	10	fp16	50 docs/session	2
CoLaR-SBR§	CIL-CORD	10	fp32	50 docs/session	3
CoLaR-SBR	Mixed	10	fp16	50 docs/session	2
CoLaR-R, sliced replay loss	CIL-CORD	10	fp16	50 docs/session	2
CoLaR, true-label memory refresh	CIL-CORD	10	fp32	50 docs/session	1
Gate controls, Tab. 11	CIL-CORD	10	fp32	50 docs/session	1 or 3
SBR, layers 1..11 frozen	CIL-CORD	10	fp32	none	1
SBR-Recall, rank 8	CIL-CORD	10	fp32	50 docs/session, none	1, 1
SBR-Recall, rank 64§	CIL-CORD, Mixed	10	fp32	none, 50 docs/session	3, 1
CoLaR-SBR + LexSlot	CIL-CORD, Mixed, DIL	10	fp32	50 docs/session	3, 3, 3
CoLaR, CoLaR-SBR, CPFD, IS3, LCA‖	DIL	10	fp32	CoLaR rows: 50 docs/task	3 (IS3: 1)
First-grid rows*	DIL	100 (CODA-Prompt 30)	unknown	ER, DER++: 200 samples	3

CORD; they are kept for the cross-backbone comparison (the EWC sign flip of Appendix F.1 is read from the Mixed rows of Tab. 23) and for completeness. "Independent" is the mean of one model trained per task from the pre-trained checkpoint.

Null cells among the fixed baselines (CPFD, IS3, CODA-Prompt). Three of the fixed baselines do not converge on the document scenarios, and we report those cells as nulls rather than as scores. The CIL-CORD and Mixed values for CPFD and IS3 below come from the earlier grid (fp32, 10-epoch cap, test-split early stopping, legacy scoring; Tab. 24); the session-restricted values in the main paper's comparison table come from later re-runs with a 100-epoch cap, which are different models, not a rescoring of these. On CIL-CORD, CPFD learns the first session (90–95 F1) and then reads 0.00 on every session from the first class-adding boundary (AA 2.7 and 0.0 on seeds 42 and 123); on Mixed it reads 6.0, 0.0 and 0.1; and on DIL, where no class is ever added, the first domain falls to $8.0/4.0/0.9$ F1 at the first boundary and the final row is zero on every domain for seed 42 and $3.0/9.7/0.0$ for seed 7 (AA $0.0/4.2/14.2$, reported as 6.1 ± 7.3 since one seed does learn the last domain), so the collapse is not a property of head growth. Two single-knob ablations on seed 42 reproduce the collapse exactly: flooring the per-sample CE weight at 0.5 (session-1 F1 0.00) and switching the distillation term off entirely (session-1 F1 2.1), so neither the adaptive CE factor nor the attention/logit distillation is the cause; what remains is the pseudo-labelling and O-token masking path, which removes the training signal on the new session's entities. IS3 learns each new session (diagonal $93/29/32/66/10$ on seed 123) but never predicts a previously learned class again (every off-diagonal entry is exactly 0.00), giving AA 4.4 ± 2.2 on CIL-CORD in the earlier grid (three seeds); on Mixed, whose last session adds no classes, it recovers there to 30.1 ± 1.2. The main comparison reports the session-restricted re-runs instead, and their retention matrices show the same patterns: CPFD learns no session after the first on either seed (seed 42 in fp32, seed 7 in fp16), and the final models of IS3 (fp32 on both seeds) and of CODA-Prompt score zero on every session but the last; LCA's merged model keeps little of the first sessions. The zero seeds of CPFD and IS3 are kept in the main table because they are not precision effects; LwF is the only row from which a collapsed seed is excluded, and that collapse occurs only in fp16. On DIL the nine-tag head never grows, so IS3's old/new split is degenerate (every entity row is "old" at every boundary and the O-token distillation spans the whole

Table 23. Generality grid (legacy scoring on CIL-CORD and Mixed, test-split early stopping): average accuracy (mean ± s.d., three seeds) of the six classical strategies on four backbones and three scenarios. *Indep.* is a per-dataset reference (one model trained independently on each dataset, three-seed macro over FUNSD/SROIE/CORD). *Joint* is joint training on the pooled data (one model, all three datasets), also a reference. Independent is only meaningful on DIL, where the task stream is three distinct datasets; CIL-CORD is one dataset split by label and Mixed is a composed stream, so Indep. is undefined there and marked N/A. Grey cells did not fit the 6 GB GPU. On DIL replay comes close to joint training on every backbone; regularisation and distillation stay within ten points of naive training on average; on CIL-CORD every method stays below joint training under this scoring, and only LwF (on BROS and BERT) rises above naive training.

Scenario	Backbone	Naive	Indep.	Joint	EWC	LwF	ER	DER++
DIL	LayoutLMv3	41.3±1.5	88.8±0.6	88.7±1.1	41.2±1.1	43.7±1.1	87.9±1.4	88.0±0.9
	LiLT	40.1±0.5	85.3±0.8	83.8±1.2	48.4±5.9	–	85.7±0.5	84.4±0.3
	BROS	40.3±1.8	88.8±0.1	87.5±1.3	45.0±4.9	35.1±3.1	87.8±0.4	87.5±1.1
	BERT	39.4±0.3	77.3±0.5	77.2±0.4	46.6±3.0	40.5±0.1	77.1±0.9	77.4±0.6
CIL-CORD	LayoutLMv3	19.0±0.2	N/A	33.3±0.3	0.5±0.6	18.8±0.2	16.0±1.4	18.2±0.3
	LiLT	19.1±0.3	N/A	32.4±0.4	–	–	17.9±0.5	18.0±1.0
	BROS	19.2±0.1	N/A	32.9±0.0	17.3±0.8	23.1±1.2	18.3±1.5	17.7±1.1
	BERT	19.3±0.1	N/A	32.4±0.2	17.9±0.3	24.3±0.3	17.1±1.6	19.2±1.9
Mixed	LayoutLMv3	33.9±0.3	N/A	67.5±0.8	22.0±9.4	35.2±1.2	60.3±5.3	60.8±2.7
	LiLT	30.7±0.7	N/A	61.8±0.6	28.1±3.0	–	57.0±1.4	55.1±2.9
	BROS	33.9±0.4	N/A	65.3±2.1	37.4±3.3	34.4±0.5	61.1±1.4	63.0±0.4
	BERT	23.4±0.3	N/A	55.0±0.6	28.6±0.9	29.4±4.2	50.2±0.6	50.7±1.3

output) and the method reduces to sequential fine-tuning under a full-output distillation term; seed 42 learns the first domain (88.2) and drops both earlier domains below 8 F1 at the next boundary (AA 38.3 vs. naive 41.3). We report that single seed rather than spend further compute on a structural limitation of the port. CODA-Prompt reads AA 0.0 on all three CIL-CORD seeds with its default pool of 10 components; enlarging the pool to 50 (10 per session) lets some sessions be learned (diagonal $79.5/40.6/0.0/18.9/36.8$) but the final row is $[0, 0, 0, 0, 36.8]$, AA 7.4, with one session never learned, so the cell stays a null. These are properties of the methods' O-tag and static-pool assumptions under five class-adding sessions, not of the sessions themselves: the same sessions are learned by naive training (AA 19.0) and by joint training (33.3), both under legacy scoring.

Per-backbone forgetting. The full BWT and AF tables for every backbone×scenario×method cell of the generality grid are generated from the run directories and will ship with the code; Tab. 23 carries the AA view.

H. Reproducibility

Hyperparameters. Documents (every method but LCA; LCA: Appendix G): AdamW, learning rate 5×10^{-5} (constant), weight decay 0.01, gradient clipping 1.0, batch size 2 with gradient checkpointing, early stopping with patience 2 and δ=0.1 F1 points with best-weight restoration. CoLaR family: k=4, r=128, 50 documents per session, 4 replayed documents per step, replay weight 1. SBR: threshold τ=0.5, all-background weight 1. SBR-Recall: rank 64, α=128 on query, key, value and dense layers above k (capacity ablation: rank 8, α=16, query/key/value). Baselines as in Appendix G. Image CIL (CIFAR-100, ImageNet-R; ViT-B/16, ten sessions): every reported cell, including the frozen-backbone and replay baselines, was trained on a 6 GB GPU at batch size 16 in fp32 with gradient checkpointing, 100-epoch cap with early stopping (patience 2), seeds 42/7/123; the CODA-Prompt, CL-LoRA and LCA image cells use this recipe unchanged.

Seeds and hardware. Seeds 42, 7 and 123 for every three-seed cell; a cell with fewer seeds shows its per-seed values. The clean runs, the gate runs and the rescore runs ran one at a time on a single NVIDIA RTX 2060 (6 GB) with about 14 GB of host memory; some rows of the first DIL grid ran on a rented GPU container (Tab. 22, first-grid rows).

Wall-clock. Tab. 7 gives the mean training-loop time per run of every headline cell, recorded by each run (the sum of the per-session training times). Our job-queue logs stamp the start and end of each job, which adds model loading and the final evaluations; for the clean CoLaR-SBR run of seed 42 the job took 2 h 01 min against 1.95 h of training loop. The h/run column of Tab. 7 gives these times for every headline

Table 24. **Fixed comparison set on LayoutLMv3 under legacy scoring** (AA, mean ± s.d. over seeds 42/7/123, legacy protocol): naive and joint training as references and the published baselines (CPFD and IS3 in the slots SLCA and RanPAC take on images), then our rows; the image-side table is Tab. 16. *CoLaR-R, sliced*: CoLaR with the replay loss restricted to the classes alive when each document was stored. Its CIL-CORD and Mixed columns are runs of the earlier grid, not the † cells of the main paper: CoLaR, CoLaR-R, LexSlot, CPFD, IS3 and LCA ran in fp32 with a 10-epoch cap; the other rows saved no configuration (grid default cap 100, 30 for CODA-Prompt). The DIL column is the main paper's. LexSlot is the 200-exemplar slot-memory recipe. The CL-LoRA row's DIL and Mixed cells and two of its CIL-CORD seeds predate the fix of our port's orthogonality penalty (Appendix G). *did not converge on these sessions, which naive (19.0) and joint training (33.3) do learn ("Null cells among the fixed baselines" below). "–": not applicable; IS3 on DIL is a single seed (fixed-label port limitation, see below).

Method	CIL-CORD	DIL	Mixed
Naive	18.98 ± 0.17	41.31 ± 1.54	33.85 ± 0.33
LwF	18.82 ± 0.15	43.66 ± 1.05	35.23 ± 1.17
ER	15.98 ± 1.36	87.85 ± 1.42	60.32 ± 5.25
DER++	18.15 ± 0.30	**88.02 ± 0.88**	**60.82 ± 2.74**
CODA-Prompt	null*	32.51 ± 1.23	8.11 ± 1.52
CL-LoRA (2025)	15.17 ± 3.14	41.14 ± 0.28	31.37 ± 0.63
CPFD (2023)	null*	6.15 ± 7.29	null*
IS3 (2024)	null*	38.29 (1 seed)	30.10 ± 1.18
LCA (2026)	8.15 ± 2.59	43.87 ± 2.45	19.01 ± 3.68
Text-only comparator (no layout or image):			
BERT-base	19.26 ± 0.11	39.42 ± 0.26	23.37 ± 0.27
CoLaR (ours)	20.38 ± 1.34	87.75 ± 0.48	58.75 ± 1.10
CoLaR-R, sliced (ours)	25.38 ± 2.38	–	61.30 ± 1.91
LexSlot (ours)	19.28 ± 0.12	87.33 ± 1.03	35.49 ± 1.39
Joint training (reference)	33.32 ± 0.33	88.73 ± 1.13	67.51 ± 0.82
Independent (one model per task)	–	88.79 ± 0.55	–

cell on this card; the joint-training reference takes well under an hour because it is one pooled run.

What will be released. The code (methods, scenarios, the training entry point and the queue scripts), the configurations, and the per-run `metrics.json` and `matrix.npy` files from which every table and figure of the paper and of this appendix is generated, together with the two generators.

I. Results in pictures

Every chart in this section is drawn by our figure generator from the same run files, with the same selection rule as the tables: a cell is clean only with its three clean seeds, legacy cells are marked † (dashed or hatched), and a cell with fewer seeds shows its seeds and n. The generator checks that what it plots equals what the tables print. Each method keeps one colour in every figure. The retention per session and the summary of the findings are in the main paper (Fig. 2 and 4); the gold spans per session are in Fig. 1.

Retention matrices (Fig. 9). Look at the diagonal (each session when it is learned) and at the bottom row (the final model). Naive training learns every session and keeps none of the earlier ones. CoLaR keeps part of the old sessions, but from session 3 on its diagonal is low: the session being trained is suppressed (rung H0). With the relabelled memory sessions 3 and 4 rise one boundary after they are learned, while the last session stays low (rung H1). The blocked readout without a memory learns every session and loses the old ones; with the memory (CoLaR-SBR) the columns hold, and under SBR-Recall every column of the mean matrix ends within 1.4 points of its diagonal.

The spread behind each mean (Fig. 10). Each row is one cell of the ladder or the comparison; the seeds, not the mean, carry every comparative sentence of the paper. The groups of runs keep their order on every seed under both metrics (Appendix B); inside the top group the seeds of SBR-Recall and joint training interleave.

Learning trajectories (Fig. 11). Every run starts from a learned first session; look at where the curves part. Without the refresh, the shared-softmax curves fall at every boundary, ER and CoLaR included; the relabelled memory rises again after session 3; the blocked readout without a memory falls towards the naive level; with a memory or with per-session deltas the blocked readout stays high throughout.

Routing (Fig. 12). Look at the diagonal. With the memory the owning block claims almost every token of its session; the largest leak is session 2's tokens claimed by block 1. Without the memory blocks 2 and 3 claim most tokens of sessions 1 to 4, the over-claiming that rung H3 attributes to drift, and no column "none" is used: old entities are not lost to "O" there.

Per class (Fig. 13). The dump re-runs repeat a clean run with its per-token outputs saved; they are not table cells. In the CoLaR re-run the session-5 classes are almost never found (the suppressed newest session of rung H0) and most session-1 classes, which hold most of the test entities, are missed, while several session-2 and session-3 classes are kept. The naive re-run finds only the total price, a class of its last session, and the joint-training re-run finds almost every class that occurs in the test set. Re-runs still in the queue join the figure when they land.

J. Further related work, and comparators we did not run

Background shift. Incremental detection has named both sides: replayed images carry current objects in their background (foreground shift [28]), and past and future objects

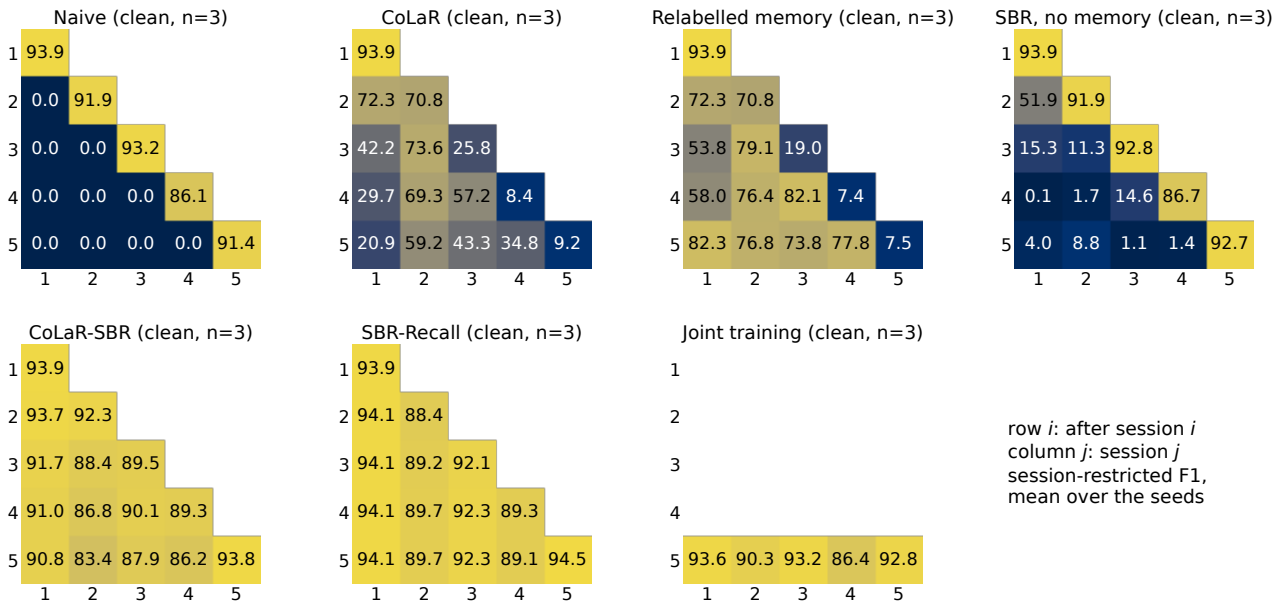


Figure 9. **Retention matrices as heatmaps** (CIL-CORD, LayoutLMv3, session-restricted F1, mean over the seeds in each title). Row i: after training session i; column j: session j. Joint training is one pooled run, so only its final row exists. Numbers: Tab. 6.

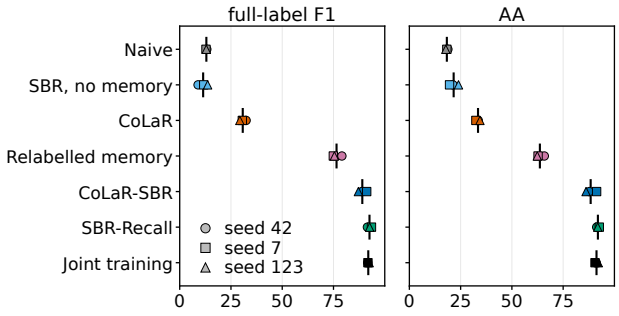


Figure 10. **Per-seed values of every clean CIL-CORD cell** under both metrics (marker: seed; bar: mean of three seeds). Numbers: Tabs. 4 and 7.

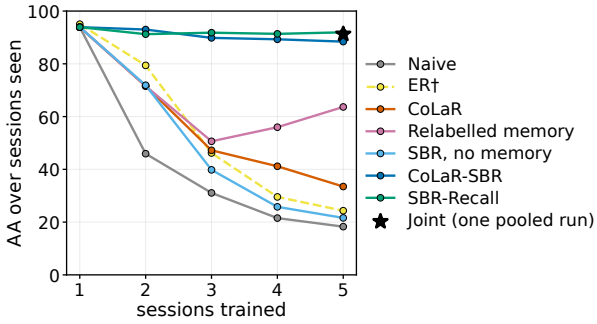


Figure 11. **AA over the sessions seen so far**, after each session (CIL-CORD, mean over the seeds; dashed: legacy protocol). Joint training is one pooled run (star).

are both labelled background, so the objectives of different stages conflict [35]. In continual NER the shift of "O" is the unlabelled-entity problem [30], answered by distillation on "O" tokens [36, 60], pseudo-labels with feature distillation [56], contrastive learning with relabelling [30], entity-triplet generation [54], or one binary output per type [58].

Task identity and disjoint tag sets. Adapter methods merge or combine per-task modules so that no task identity is needed [26, 52, 61]. Outside CL, taggers trained on datasets with disjoint tag sets either marginalise over the tags a dataset does not annotate [12] or share one tagging layer through a tag hierarchy [2]; the first is the loss MiB uses, and we make no claim that separation beats it in general.

Latent replay and drift. REMIND, Latent Replay and generative replay replay mid-network representations through the plastic upper layers [14, 37, 49]; exemplar-free methods keep class statistics instead [8, 11, 38, 57, 62]. Our memory keeps whole documents, one truncated SVD each, a per-sequence factorisation used to compress key caches [47]. Forgetting in image classifiers sits in the layers nearest the output [40], and in domain-incremental segmentation freezing early layers moves the representation shift to later ones [19]. Continual relation extraction [9, 13, 59], like continual NER, is sentence-level and text-only. The broader

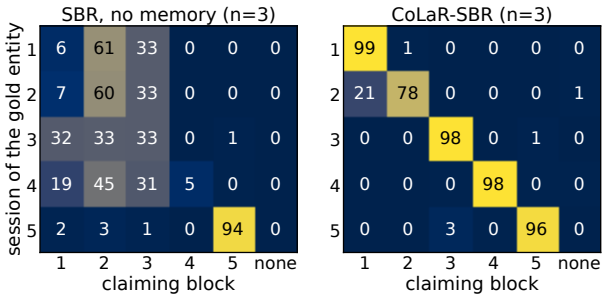


Figure 12. **Which block claims each session's gold entity tokens** (rows: session of the gold entity, on its own test split; columns: the block with the largest claim above 0.5, or none; first-subword tokens pooled over the three clean seeds; % of the row). Per-seed counts: the routing of Tab. 3.

CL families [3, 22, 25, 29, 31, 41, 43, 46, 53] are surveyed by Wang et al. [51].

Comparators we did not run. From this literature: a faithful ICE-O (frozen encoder, one head per session, constant Other logit), SBR with a constant background, a separated softmax with one shared background, per-class sigmoid heads (SSUL, SpanKL), MiB's distillation, PLOP and BPF. The MiB-style loss of rung H2 is the background-shift correction we queue on the same memory.

References

[1] Hongjoon Ahn, Jihwan Kwak, Subin Lim, Hyeonsu Bang, Hyojun Kim, and Taesup Moon. SS-IL: Separated softmax for incremental learning. In *Proceedings of the IEEE/CVF International Conference on Computer Vision (ICCV)*, pages 844–853, 2021.

[2] Genady Beryozkin, Yoel Drori, Oren Gilon, Tzvika Hartman, and Idan Szpektor. A joint named-entity recognizer for heterogeneous tag-sets using a tag hierarchy. In *Proceedings of the 57th Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics (ACL)*, pages 140–150, 2019. 21

[3] Pietro Buzzega, Matteo Boschini, Angelo Porrello, Davide Abati, and Simone Calderara. Dark experience for general continual learning: A strong, simple baseline. In *Advances in Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS)*, 2020. 22

[4] Lucas Caccia, Rahaf Aljundi, Nader Asadi, Tinne Tuytelaars, Joelle Pineau, and Eugene Belilovsky. New insights on reducing abrupt representation change in online continual learning. In *International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR)*, 2022. 10

[5] Fabio Cermelli, Massimiliano Mancini, Samuel Rota Bulò, Elisa Ricci, and Barbara Caputo. Modeling the background for incremental learning in semantic segmentation. In *Proceedings of the IEEE/CVF Conference on Computer Vision and Pattern Recognition (CVPR)*, 2020.

[6] Sungmin Cha and Kyunghyun Cho. Hyperparameters in continual learning: A reality check. *Transactions on Machine Learning Research (TMLR)*, 2025.

[7] Sungmin Cha, Beomyoung Kim, YoungJoon Yoo, and Taesup Moon. SSUL: Semantic segmentation with unknown label for exemplar-based class-incremental learning. In *Advances in Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS)*, 2021.

[8] Jinpeng Chen, Runmin Cong, Yuxuan Luo, Horace Ip, and Sam Kwong. Saving 100x storage: Prototype replay for reconstructing training sample distribution in class-incremental semantic segmentation. In *Advances in Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS)*, 2023. 21

[9] Li Cui, Deqing Yang, Jiaxin Yu, Chengwei Hu, Jiayang Cheng, Jingjie Yi, and Yanghua Xiao. Refining sample embeddings with relation prototypes to enhance continual relation extraction. In *Proceedings of the 59th Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics (ACL-IJCNLP)*, 2021. 21

[10] Arthur Douillard, Yifu Chen, Arnaud Dapogny, and Matthieu Cord. PLOP: Learning without forgetting for continual semantic segmentation. In *Proceedings of the IEEE/CVF Conference on Computer Vision and Pattern Recognition (CVPR)*, pages 4040–4050, 2021.

[11] Dipam Goswami, Yuyang Liu, Bartłomiej Twardowski, and Joost van de Weijer. FeCAM: Exploiting the heterogeneity of class distributions in exemplar-free continual learning. In *Advances in Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS)*, 2023. 21

[12] Nathan Greenberg, Trapit Bansal, Patrick Verga, and Andrew McCallum. Marginal likelihood training of BiLSTM-CRF for biomedical named entity recognition from disjoint label sets. In *Proceedings of the 2018 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing (EMNLP)*, pages 2824–2829, 2018. 21

[13] Xu Han, Yi Dai, Tianyu Gao, Yankai Lin, Zhiyuan Liu, Peng Li, Maosong Sun, and Jie Zhou. Continual relation learning via episodic memory activation and reconsolidation. In *Proceedings of the 58th Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics (ACL)*, 2020. 21

[14] Tyler L. Hayes, Kushal Kafle, Robik Shrestha, Manoj Acharya, and Christopher Kanan. REMIND your neural network to prevent catastrophic forgetting. In *European Conference on Computer Vision (ECCV)*, 2020. 21

[15] Jiangpeng He, Zhihao Duan, and Fengqing Zhu. CL-LoRA: Continual low-rank adaptation for rehearsal-free class-incremental learning. In *Proceedings of the IEEE/CVF Conference on Computer Vision and Pattern Recognition (CVPR)*, pages 30534–30544, 2025.

[16] Teakgyu Hong, Donghyun Kim, Mingi Ji, Wonseok Hwang, Daehyun Nam, and Sungrae Park. BROS: A pre-trained language model focusing on text and layout for better key information extraction from documents. In *Proceedings of the AAAI Conference on Artificial Intelligence*, pages 10767–10775, 2022.

[17] Edward J. Hu, Yelong Shen, Phillip Wallis, Zeyuan Allen-Zhu, Yuanzhi Li, Shean Wang, Lu Wang, and Weizhu Chen. LoRA: Low-rank adaptation of large language models. In *In-*

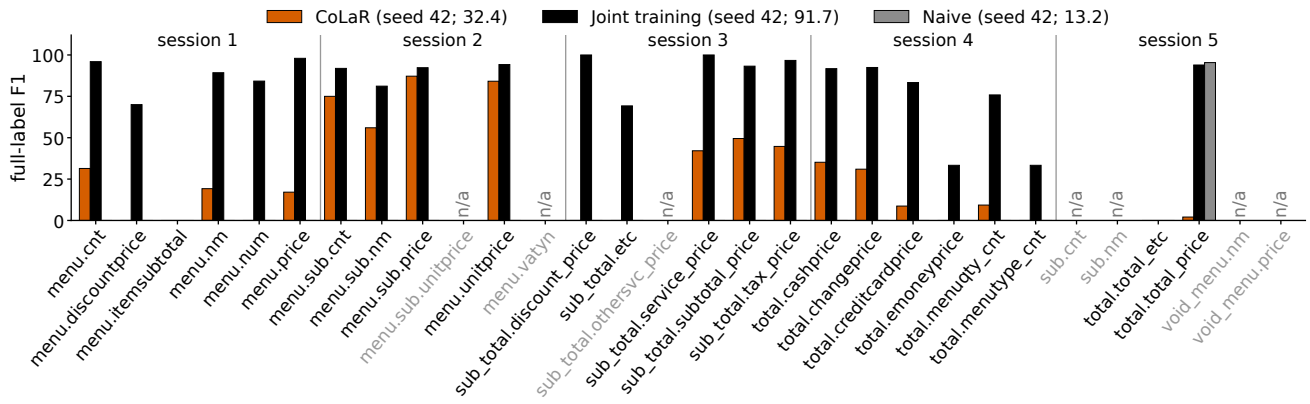


Figure 13. **Per-class full-label F1** of the prediction-dump re-runs on disk (CIL-CORD, final model on the unmasked test set; seed 42, one run each; the legend names each run with its full-label F1). Classes grouped by the session that introduces them; n/a (grey): the class does not occur in the test set.

ternational Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR), 2022.

[18] Yupan Huang, Tengchao Lv, Lei Cui, Yutong Lu, and Furu Wei. LayoutLMv3: Pre-training for document AI with unified text and image masking. In *Proceedings of the 30th ACM International Conference on Multimedia (MM)*, pages 4083–4091, 2022.

[19] Tobias Kalb and Jürgen Beyerer. Principles of forgetting in domain-incremental semantic segmentation in adverse weather conditions. In *Proceedings of the IEEE/CVF Conference on Computer Vision and Pattern Recognition (CVPR)*, 2023. arXiv:2303.14115. 11, 21

[20] Gyuhak Kim, Bing Liu, and Zixuan Ke. A multi-head model for continual learning via out-of-distribution replay. In *Proceedings of the First Conference on Lifelong Learning Agents (CoLLAs)*, pages 548–563, 2022.

[21] Gyuhak Kim, Changnan Xiao, Tatsuya Konishi, Zixuan Ke, and Bing Liu. A theoretical study on solving continual learning. In *Advances in Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS)*, 2022.

[22] James Kirkpatrick, Razvan Pascanu, Neil Rabinowitz, Joel Veness, Guillaume Desjardins, Andrei A. Rusu, Kieran Milan, John Quan, Tiago Ramalho, Agnieszka Grabska-Barwinska, et al. Overcoming catastrophic forgetting in neural networks. *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences (PNAS)*, 114(13):3521–3526, 2017. 22

[23] Ritesh Kumar, Saurabh Goyal, Ashish Verma, and Vatche Isahagian. ProtoNER: Few shot incremental learning for named entity recognition using prototypical networks. In *Business Process Management Workshops (BPM 2023 International Workshops)*, pages 70–82. Springer, 2024.

[24] Siqi Li, Yufan Shen, Xiangnan Chen, Jiayi Chen, Hengwei Ju, Haodong Duan, Song Mao, Hongbin Zhou, Bo Zhang, Bin Fu, Pinlong Cai, Licheng Wen, Botian Shi, Yong Liu, Xinyu Cai, and Yu Qiao. GDI-Bench: A benchmark for general document intelligence with vision and reasoning decoupling. *arXiv preprint arXiv:2505.00063*, 2025.

[25] Zhizhong Li and Derek Hoiem. Learning without forgetting. In *European Conference on Computer Vision (ECCV)*, 2016. 22

[26] Yan-Shuo Liang and Wu-Jun Li. InfLoRA: Interference-free low-rank adaptation for continual learning. In *Proceedings of the IEEE/CVF Conference on Computer Vision and Pattern Recognition (CVPR)*, pages 23638–23647, 2024. 21

[27] Minqian Liu and Lifu Huang. Teamwork is not always good: An empirical study of classifier drift in class-incremental information extraction. In *Findings of the Association for Computational Linguistics: ACL*, 2023.

[28] Yuyang Liu, Yang Cong, Dipam Goswami, Xialei Liu, and Joost van de Weijer. Augmented box replay: Overcoming foreground shift for incremental object detection. In *Proceedings of the IEEE/CVF International Conference on Computer Vision (ICCV)*, 2023. 20

[29] David Lopez-Paz and Marc'Aurelio Ranzato. Gradient episodic memory for continual learning. In *Advances in Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS)*, 2017. 22

[30] Ruotian Ma, Xuanting Chen, Lin Zhang, Xin Zhou, Junzhe Wang, Tao Gui, Qi Zhang, Xiang Gao, and Yunwen Chen. Learning "O" helps for learning more: Handling the unlabeled entity problem for class-incremental NER. In *Proceedings of the 61st Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics (ACL)*, pages 5959–5979, 2023. 21

[31] Arun Mallya and Svetlana Lazebnik. PackNet: Adding multiple tasks to a single network by iterative pruning. In *Proceedings of the IEEE/CVF Conference on Computer Vision and Pattern Recognition (CVPR)*, 2018. 22

[32] Marc Masana, Xialei Liu, Bartłomiej Twardowski, Mikel Menta, Andrew D. Bagdanov, and Joost van de Weijer. Class-incremental learning: Survey and performance evaluation on image classification. *IEEE Transactions on Pattern Analysis and Machine Intelligence*, 45(5):5513–5533, 2023.

[33] Michael McCloskey and Neal J. Cohen. Catastrophic interference in connectionist networks: The sequential learning

problem. *Psychology of Learning and Motivation*, 24:109–165, 1989.

[34] Mohammad Minouei, Khurram Azeem Hashmi, Mohammad Reza Soheili, Muhammad Zeshan Afzal, and Didier Stricker. Continual learning for table detection in document images. *Applied Sciences*, 12(18):8969, 2022.

[35] Qijie Mo, Yipeng Gao, Shenghao Fu, Junkai Yan, Ancong Wu, and Wei-Shi Zheng. Bridge past and future: Overcoming information asymmetry in incremental object detection. In *European Conference on Computer Vision (ECCV)*, pages 463–480. Springer, 2024. 21

[36] Natawut Monaikul, Giuseppe Castellucci, Simone Filice, and Oleg Rokhlenko. Continual learning for named entity recognition. In *Proceedings of the AAAI Conference on Artificial Intelligence*, pages 13570–13577, 2021. 21

[37] Lorenzo Pellegrini, Gabriele Graffieti, Vincenzo Lomonaco, and Davide Maltoni. Latent replay for real-time continual learning. In *IEEE/RSJ International Conference on Intelligent Robots and Systems (IROS)*, 2020. 21

[38] Grégoire Petit, Adrian Popescu, Hugo Schindler, David Picard, and Bertrand Delezoide. FeTrIL: Feature translation for exemplar-free class-incremental learning. In *Proceedings of the IEEE/CVF Winter Conference on Applications of Computer Vision (WACV)*, 2023. 21

[39] Shengjie Qiu, Junhao Zheng, Zhen Liu, Yicheng Luo, and Qianli Ma. Incremental sequence labeling: A tale of two shifts. In *Findings of the Association for Computational Linguistics: ACL 2024*, pages 777–791, 2024. arXiv:2402.10447.

[40] Vinay V. Ramasesh, Ethan Dyer, and Maithra Raghu. Anatomy of catastrophic forgetting: Hidden representations and task semantics. In *International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR)*, 2021. 11, 21

[41] Sylvestre-Alvise Rebuffi, Alexander Kolesnikov, Georg Sperl, and Christoph H. Lampert. iCaRL: Incremental classifier and representation learning. In *Proceedings of the IEEE Conference on Computer Vision and Pattern Recognition (CVPR)*, 2017. 22

[42] David Rolnick, Arun Ahuja, Jonathan Schwarz, Timothy P. Lillicrap, and Greg Wayne. Experience replay for continual learning. In *Advances in Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS)*, 2019.

[43] Gobinda Saha, Isha Garg, and Kaushik Roy. Gradient projection memory for continual learning. In *International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR)*, 2021. 22

[44] Abdellatif Sassioui, Yasser Elouargui, Mohamed El Kamili, Rachid Benouini, El Mehdi Benyoussef, Meriyem Chergui, and Mohammed Ouzzif. AMD-Proj: Adaptive memory-driven selective gradient projection for continual learning in document understanding. *Technologies*, 14(5):250, 2026.

[45] Abdellatif Sassioui, Yasser Elouargui, Mohamed El Kamili, Rachid Benouini, El Mehdi Benyoussef, Meriyem Chergui, and Mohamed Ouzzif. When documents evolve: Decomposing catastrophic forgetting in layout-aware document models. In *International Conference on Wireless Communications and Mobile Computing (IWCMC)*, pages 1124–1129, 2026.

[46] James Seale Smith, Leonid Karlinsky, Vyshnavi Gutta, Paola Cascante-Bonilla, Donghyun Kim, Assaf Arbelle, Rameswar Panda, Rogerio Feris, and Zsolt Kira. CODA-Prompt: Continual decomposed attention-based prompting for rehearsal-free continual learning. In *Proceedings of the IEEE/CVF Conference on Computer Vision and Pattern Recognition (CVPR)*, 2023. 22

[47] Hanshi Sun, Li-Wen Chang, Wenlei Bao, Size Zheng, Ningxin Zheng, Xin Liu, Harry Dong, Yuejie Chi, and Beidi Chen. ShadowKV: KV cache in shadows for high-throughput long-context LLM inference. In *Proceedings of the 42nd International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML)*, pages 57355–57373, 2025. 21

[48] Tung Tran, Danilo Vasconcellos Vargas, and Khoat Than. LCA: Local classifier alignment for continual learning. In *International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR)*, 2026.

[49] Gido M. van de Ven, Hava T. Siegelmann, and Andreas S. Tolias. Brain-inspired replay for continual learning with artificial neural networks. *Nature Communications*, 11:4069, 2020. 21

[50] Jiapeng Wang, Lianwen Jin, and Kai Ding. LiLT: A simple yet effective language-independent layout transformer for structured document understanding. In *Proceedings of the 60th Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics (ACL)*, 2022.

[51] Liyuan Wang, Xingxing Zhang, Hang Su, and Jun Zhu. A comprehensive survey of continual learning: Theory, method and application. *IEEE Transactions on Pattern Analysis and Machine Intelligence (TPAMI)*, 46(8):5362–5383, 2024. 22

[52] Xiao Wang, Tianze Chen, Qiming Ge, Han Xia, Rong Bao, Rui Zheng, Qi Zhang, Tao Gui, and Xuanjing Huang. Orthogonal subspace learning for language model continual learning. In *Findings of the Association for Computational Linguistics: EMNLP*, 2023. 21

[53] Zifeng Wang, Zizhao Zhang, Chen-Yu Lee, Han Zhang, Ruoxi Sun, Xiaoqi Ren, Guolong Su, Vincent Perot, Jennifer Dy, and Tomas Pfister. Learning to prompt for continual learning. In *Proceedings of the IEEE/CVF Conference on Computer Vision and Pattern Recognition (CVPR)*, 2022. 22

[54] Yawen Yang, Fukun Ma, Shiao Meng, Aiwei Liu, and Lijie Wen. GenCNER: A generative framework for continual named entity recognition. In *2025 International Joint Conference on Neural Networks (IJCNN)*, pages 1–9, 2025. arXiv:2510.11444. 21

[55] Yuexiang Zhai, Shengbang Tong, Xiao Li, Mu Cai, Qing Qu, Yong Jae Lee, and Yi Ma. Investigating the catastrophic forgetting in multimodal large language model fine-tuning. In *Proceedings of the Conference on Parsimony and Learning (CPAL)*, pages 202–227, 2024.

[56] Duzhen Zhang, Wei Cong, Jiahua Dong, Yahan Yu, Xiuyi Chen, Yonggang Zhang, and Zhen Fang. Continual named entity recognition without catastrophic forgetting. In *Proceedings of the 2023 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing (EMNLP)*, 2023. 21

[57] Gengwei Zhang, Liyuan Wang, Guoliang Kang, Ling Chen, and Yunchao Wei. SLCA: Slow learner with classifier alignment for continual learning on a pre-trained model. In *Proceedings of the IEEE/CVF International Conference on Computer Vision (ICCV)*, pages 19091–19101, 2023. 21

[58] Yunan Zhang and Qingcai Chen. A neural span-based continual named entity recognition model. In *Proceedings of the AAAI Conference on Artificial Intelligence*, pages 13993–14001, 2023. 21

[59] Kang Zhao, Hua Xu, Jiangong Yang, and Kai Gao. Consistent representation learning for continual relation extraction. In *Findings of the Association for Computational Linguistics: ACL 2022*, 2022. 21

[60] Junhao Zheng, Zhanxian Liang, Haibin Chen, and Qianli Ma. Distilling causal effect from miscellaneous other-class for continual named entity recognition. In *Proceedings of the 2022 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing (EMNLP)*, pages 3602–3615, 2022. 21

[61] Da-Wei Zhou, Hai-Long Sun, Han-Jia Ye, and De-Chuan Zhan. Expandable subspace ensemble for pre-trained model-based class-incremental learning. In *Proceedings of the IEEE/CVF Conference on Computer Vision and Pattern Recognition (CVPR)*, pages 23554–23564, 2024. 21

[62] Fei Zhu, Xu-Yao Zhang, Chuang Wang, Fei Yin, and Cheng-Lin Liu. Prototype augmentation and self-supervision for incremental learning. In *Proceedings of the IEEE/CVF Conference on Computer Vision and Pattern Recognition (CVPR)*, 2021. 21